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The Tale of Sudhana and Manoharā on Candi Jago: An Interpretation of a Series of Narrative Bas-reliefs on a 13th-Century East Javanese Monument

KATE O'BRIEN

CANDI JAGO IS LOCATED AT TUMPANG, some fourteen kilometres east of Malang in East Java.¹ It is commonly held that the shrine was commissioned in AD 1268 by King Kṛtanagara on the death of his father, Viṣṇuvardhana, with a date of completion around 1280 to coincide with funeral rites held twelve years after death. Its relatively small size and current state of deterioration possibly belie the scope of its importance. This monument came into existence during a dramatic period not only in Javanese history, but in the history of East and Southeast Asia. This was the time of Khubilai Khan, whose expansionist aims throughout Asia were known to include Java. However, with Kṛtanagara also keen to broaden his sovereignty well beyond Java, conflict was inevitable. Tension between China and Java may well have continued until the Yuan dynasty came to an end in 1368. As I have indicated elsewhere (O'Brien 1988, 1990, 1993, 2008, 2011), much of the design and embellishment of Candi Jago reflects the tension of those times.

Since the publication of Brandes' extensive monograph on Candi Jago in 1904,² most of the narratives portrayed on its five tiers of bas-relief panels have been identified. However, for some years

two series did continue to resist efforts at positive identification. One is located on the southern and eastern faces of the first terrace (see Diagram 12.1³) and has since been interpreted in terms of a Buddhist redaction of the *Aji Dharma* tale.⁴ The second series begins at the eastern end of the southern face of the *beugel*⁵ and continues on the eastern and northern faces of this same band. This latter series—the subject of this chapter—was interpreted some years ago⁶ as being an extension of the *Kuñjarakarna* tale, which had much earlier been correctly identified among the reliefs of the first terrace and *beugel* by van Stein Callenfels (1916: 445ff.).

As an alternative identification, I propose to show that in fact the second unidentified series is the tale of the Bodhisattva prince Sudhana and the *kinnarī* princess Manoharā. As will become apparent, such an interpretation is not without problems. However, it would seem to supply far more satisfactory explanations for the great majority of scenes within this bas-relief series than can be provided by attempting to rationalize them as an extension of the *Kuñjarakarna* tale.

1. I would like to acknowledge the assistance of a number of colleagues and friends who have kindly read this work in its various drafts and offered numerous valuable suggestions for its improvement, in particular, Roy Jordaen, Andrea Aciri, and Ian Dunn. For the many shortcomings that no doubt remain, I am solely responsible.

2. All references ('Brandes ph.*') herein relate to numbered photographs as published in that monograph, all of which may be viewed on the Digital Sources website of Leiden University (<https://socrates.leidenuniv.nl>, then to 'Kern Institute'). As Brandes photographed Jago's reliefs in the opposite direction to the flow of all the narratives, the plate numbers are now read (left to right) in reverse.

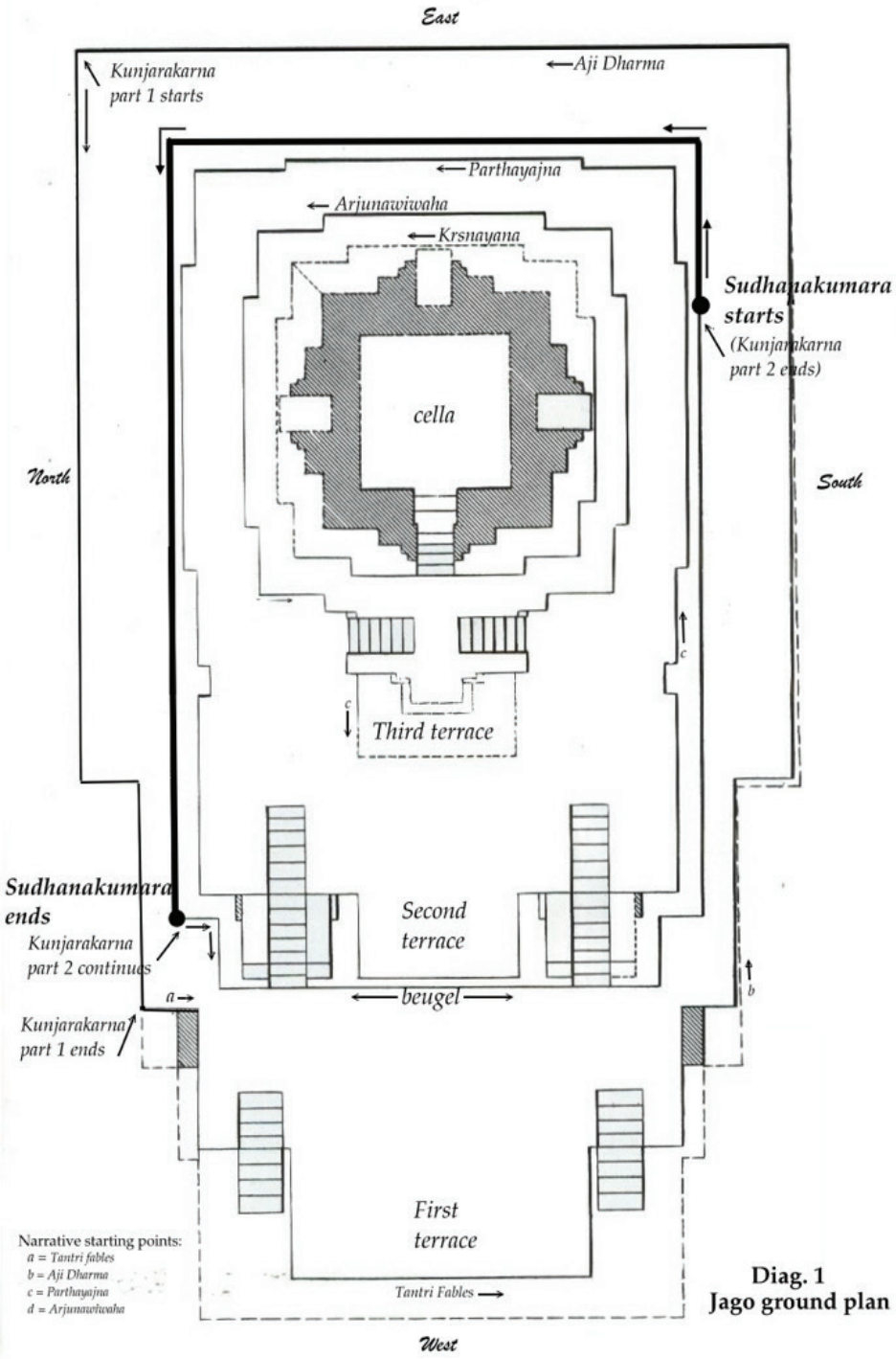
3. Diagram 1 is a skeletal plan of Candi Jago showing the layout of the bas-relief narratives on their various terraces. The points marking the start and finish of each story are indicated thereon.

4. Also known as *Angling-darma* (Rdn. Bambang Soetrisno 1985), and *Aridharma* (Hunter 2000: 69–102).

5. The *beugel* is a narrow band of reliefs girding the base of the second terrace (see Diag. 1). *Beugel* appears to have been a descriptive term used by Brandes and is retained here for its one-word convenience.

6. See Departemen Pendidikan dan Kebudayaan 1977, and also Soetrisno 1985: 14–20. No comparison with either of these two works will be made here in order not to further complicate an already multifaceted discussion of damaged reliefs.

Diagram 12.1: Plan of Candi Jago showing the layout of the bas-relief narratives. (Drawing: author)



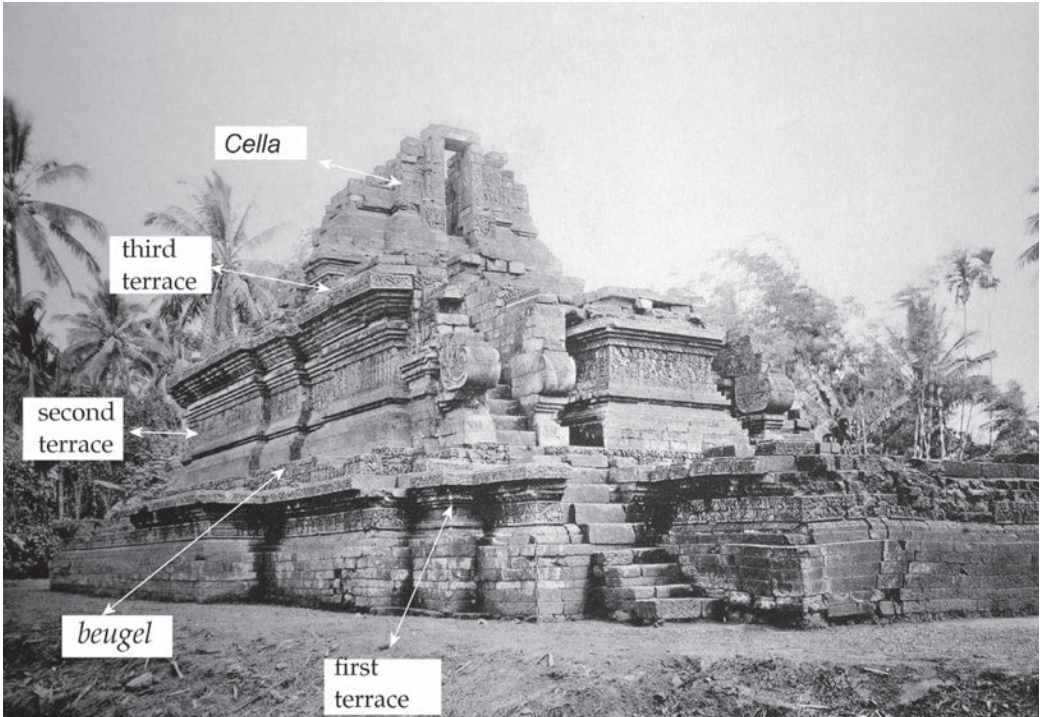


Fig. 12.1a: Candi Jago. (Original photo: Brandes N.W. 234)

The romantic tale of Sudhana and Manoharā is well known throughout Asia and Southeast Asia, and has evidently been so for many centuries.⁷ What gives added interest as regards Candi Jago, is the presence of the *amoghapāśa* ('unfailing noose') within this tale. The *amoghapāśa* is a major attribute of the bodhisattva Amoghapāśa Lokeśvara, its purpose being to snare unenlightened beings and lead them to nirvana. It becomes significant then, that Amoghapāśa Lokeśvara (inscribed *bharāla āryāmoghapāśa lokeśvara*) is also the central divinity of Jago's statuary. Jago's particular emanation of Amoghapāśa is a white form, eight-armed and accompanied by the divinities Śyāmatārā, Sudhanakumāra, Bhṛkuṭī, and Hayagrīva.

Evidence of devotion to the emanation of Avalokiteśvara known as Amoghapāśa Lokeśvara can be traced back as far as the late 6th century in East Asia (Leoshko 1985: 128) and late 8th century in

Southeast Asia (Lunsingh Scheurleer and Klokke 1988: 58), but is strangely scarce if not completely absent in India. The forms of Amoghapāśa are many and varied but Pal (1967: 26) notes that it is the eight-armed figure that gained prominence in Java, Tibet, and Nepal. This divinity is much venerated in Tibet and particularly in Nepal, where the *Aṣṭamīvrata* rite—during which images of the deity are consecrated—is still performed by Newar Buddhists on the eighth day of the month, with numerous *paṭas* and *maṇḍalas* going back as far as the 16th century attesting to his worship (Pal 1985: 31, 68 [P18], 214). The iconography of Jago's Amoghapāśa and that of the four companion statues closely follows a *sādhana* known to have been composed by the great Kashmiri scholar, Śākyaśrībhadrā (AD 1127–225),⁸ much revered in Tibetan Buddhism. I will return to this figure in the final discussion.

Success in the most esoteric forms of Tantric practice was believed not only to bring Buddhahood in life to the devotee, but also potential access

7. Concerning the diversity of this tale, see for example Padmanabh S. Jaini's extensive survey (1966: 533ff.) and, more recently, Csaba Dezső 2014: 74.

8. O'Brien 1993: 252–55; Schoterman 1994: 154–77.

to extraordinary magical powers. This concept certainly seems to have gained the interest of a number of rulers in Asia and Southeast Asia by the time of Khubilai Khan.⁹ Attainment is achieved through the union of Wisdom and Compassion¹⁰ that is expressed at the highest level of Non-duality in the union of the female and male principles (respectively) and is said to bring forth the Buddha as 'son'.¹¹ This triad of father/mother/son is described in precisely these terms in the Old Javanese *San Hyan Kamahāyānikan* of indeterminate dating (Kats 1910: 48)¹² and the *Sutasoma* of the 14th century (O'Brien 2008: 56, 208). I would argue that the establishment of such a triad was King Kṛtanagara's plan in deifying his father as the Bodhisattva, Amoghapāśa Lokeśvara, in Candi Jago.¹³ Accordingly, Kṛtanagara's *abhiṣeka*

name refers to his being a Jina(-Buddha) but as the oneness of Śiva and Buddha at the highest level of truth.¹⁴ Essential to the most esoteric practice is the 'right' female partner. For Kṛtanagara this was Śrī Bajradevī and in death we find the couple commemorated as Vairocana and Locanā (Robson 1995: 56). Thus, the identification of Kṛtanagara as Buddha Vairocana ties well with the interment image of his father in the particular eight-armed, white form of Amoghapāśa who occupied Vairocana's central position in Jago's *maṇḍala*.¹⁵

At a more secular level, fundamental to the Javanese concept of ideal kingship is the importance of the 'right' queen and the obligation on the king to pursue that quest, since it is the queen who embodies the fertility and good fortune of the kingdom. I have long maintained that Candi Jago, while fulfilling its commemorative role of housing the divine image of a dead king, is at the same time an exposé on the rising status of Buddhist-empowered kings of Java. So it is perhaps no surprise that besides the power of the *pāśa* to ensnare beings and draw them towards enlightenment, in the tale of the Bodhisattva prince Sudhana it is also the means of capturing his ideal wife and future queen, the *kinnarī* princess Manoharā.¹⁶

9. Perhaps one of the earliest examples of royal initiation in the highest Tantras is the *sādhana* devised by Atiśa for the king of Western Tibet some three centuries earlier. The *sādhana* is based on the *Guhyasamājatantra* and its *maṇḍala* is emanated with Amitābha at its centre (Roerich 1949: 250–51; also O'Brien 1993: Appendix 2). How this process came to gain wider royal interest may be uncertain, but by the 12th century there are notable examples: Jayavarman VII (Cambodia, r. 1181–1218, see also n. 16, below); Kṛtanagara and Khubilai Khan, 13th century; and various Japanese emperors from late 13th century on (Kamikawa 1990)—all initiated in one form or other of the Ādibuddha. On the nature of the politico-religious rivalry between Kṛtanagara and Khubilai, see Bade in this volume.

10. Also known as 'Wisdom and Means': it carries all the same connotations since 'Means' motivated by universal Compassion are deemed to be inseparable.

11. In Tibetan (and Nepalese) *maṇḍalas* where the male and female divinities are shown in union, they are described as *yab-yum* ('father-mother').

12. Various opinions have placed its compilation as early as the first half of the 10th century and as late as the 14th or even 15th century.

13. *Deśavarṇana*: Canto 41.4ab (Robson 1995: 54). Given the absence of epigraphic evidence, Griffiths (2010: 361) counsels caution in accepting that the Amoghapāśa statue of Jago was intended as the deified image of Viṣṇuvardhana. This will always be a moot point. Even Prapañca, author of the *Deśavarṇana*, was gently cautioned by his informant, an elderly abbot, as to the complete accuracy of all the details he was about to impart, since they were based on oral traditions (Robson 1995: 52ff.). However, Viṣṇuvardhana's enshrinement image is far from the only one mentioned,

there being a number of other rulers mentioned covering a span of more than a century. Although of later dating, the *Pararaton* also mentions the enshrinement of Viṣṇuvardhana at Jago (Brandes 1920: 24, 77).

14. In the *Deśavarṇana*, the consecration name is given 'as a Jina, Jñānabajreśvara' (Robson 1995: 55). The 1351 Singhasari inscription gives it as 'Śrī Jñāneśvarabajra'; the *Pararaton*, as *Bhātāra Śivabuddha* (Brandes 1920: 24).

15. It may well be that a similar situation had already been earlier adopted in Cambodia with the triads founded by Jayavarman VII. By deifying the images of his deceased father and mother as Lokeśvara (Bodhisattva of Compassion) and Prajñāpāramitā (Perfection of Wisdom) he would be in a position to build his claim as Buddha-king, and indeed the king's triad of Lokeśvara, Prajñāpāramitā, and the Buddha seems to have 'dominated the first decade of his reign' (Sharrock 2007: 234). Supported then by subsequent Tantric initiation rites to the great Tantric deity, Hevajra, he later projected this vision of himself as supreme Buddha in the multiple faces of the Ādi-Buddha, Vajrasattva, on his regnal temple at the Bayon (Sharrock 2007: 230–81).

16. The quest for the right queen is also the subject of two other tales illustrated on Jago, in particular the *Kṛṣṇāyaṇa* on the damaged *cella* walls and the *Aji Dharma* tale on the

While evidence of the Sudhana and Manoharā tale in Java has not as yet been unearthed among extant manuscripts, its appearance among the reliefs of Borobudur suggests that it had at least some currency in Central Java by the 8th century, when Buddhism flourished there. The story as it appears on Borobudur was not correctly identified until late in the 19th century. However, there were still problems in resolving some of its episodes and Krom, though he consulted many texts, was not able to precisely match the Borobudur version with any known sources of the tale.¹⁷ On the basis of his survey, Jaini proposed that while the Borobudur reliefs show affinity with the *Sudhanakumārāvadāna* from the *Divyāvadāna* collection, they also appear to share details found in later Pali recensions of the tale, suggesting an intermediate, unknown version (Jaini 1966: 555, 558).

Similar difficulties are met with Jago's 'Sudhana'. Even though the present work draws on three Buddhist versions, i.e. the *Sudhanāvadāna* occurring

in the Tibetan canon,¹⁸ a *Kinnarī* contained in the *Mahāvastu*,¹⁹ and a third version of Khotanese origin,²⁰ problems are still encountered. Whether any of these or some other localized text inspired the artisans of Jago is yet to be made clear, for as noted by Fontein (1981: 92) in his discussion of a particular panel in the Sudhana-Manoharā reliefs on Borobudur:

Like some of the reliefs of Prambanan, this relief from Barabaður suggests the possibility that later texts from all over Southeast Asia may have preserved divergent traditions which found their expression in the reliefs of Barabaður, and that such material should not be excluded from our research simply because it was so obviously committed to writing long after Barabaður was built.

first terrace. In the *Kṛṣṇāyana kakavin*, King Kṛṣṇa rejects the wife chosen for him, taking instead the Princess Rukmiṇī by abduction even though his action brings about war (Krom 1974: 284–90). The origin and interpretation of the *Aji Dharma* reliefs on Jago are ongoing problems and the reader is referred to Hunter 2000: 69–102 for an in-depth discussion. In essence, the queen has taken her own life as a result of misadventure by the couple. Aji Dharma is so grief-stricken that he journeys in quest of his lost love, convinced she is by now reincarnated. The narrative reliefs suggest their reunion. Among the other stories depicted, in the *Pārthayajña* (second terrace), the ruling Pāṇḍava clan have been tricked into the loss of their kingdom. It falls to Arjuna to take up the yoke of asceticism in order to win the favour of the gods and regain his family's right to reign. The *Arjunavivāha*, on the third terrace, sees Arjuna granted the magical Paśupati weapon with which he will re-establish his family's right to rule. However, god Indra first draws Arjuna into his own battle against the demon king Nivātakavaca who currently threatens heaven. Arjuna defeats the demon king and is rewarded by Indra with temporary marriage to a number of celestial nymphs in Indra's heaven (Krom 1974: 234–49).

17. For information concerning the earliest scholars to have worked with the Sudhana reliefs on Borobudur, see Krom 1927: 230ff. and Jaini 1966. For a more recent examination of the *Sudhanakumārāvadāna* tale as depicted on Borobudur, see Miksic 1990: 77–81 and Levin 2011: 191–204.

18. Originally translated from the Tibetan *Kah-gyur* into German by F. Anton von Schiefner in 1882 and later translated from the German into English by W.R.S. Ralston: *Tibetan Tales derived from Indian Sources* (1906: 44–74). An identical Sanskrit version of this *avadāna* is apparently also held in the *Divyāvadāna* collection of Nepalese manuscripts (copies held in Cambridge and Paris). This collection was transcribed but not translated by Edward B. Cowell and Robert A. Neil in *The Divyāvadāna—A Collection of Early Buddhist Legends* (repr. 1970), in which the tale is given the name *Sudhanakumāra* ('Young Sudhana'). For the convenience of this study, I have made extensive use of Ralston's English translation based on von Schiefner's *Kah-gyur* version in German, and page numbers cited will refer to Ralston's volume. Therefore, all references to 'the *avadāna*' herein will denote the *Kah-gyur* version. I am also indebted to Andrea Acri, who has alerted me to a very recent critical edition and English translation by Csaba Dezső (2014) of an incomplete manuscript of the Sudhana-Manoharā tale held under the auspices of the Nepal-German Manuscript Preservation Project. The text is believed to have been written in Bengal by the Buddhist scholar, Śāntākara Gupta, and is possibly datable to the late 11th century.

19. J.J. Jones, *The Mahāvastu*, Vol. II (1952: 91–111).

20. H.W. Bailey, 'The Sudhana Poem of Ṛddhiprabhāva' (1966: 506–32). This version by Ṛddhiprabhāva was one of three Khotanese texts in Saka language examined by Bailey. He observed that it differed from the other two 'markedly in phrases, in additional verses, and in orthography [being written] in a less developed form of the language'. Bailey also noted a colophon by Ṛddhiprabhāva stating that he had taken the tale from an ancient *śāstra* (1966: 506).

Or, as observed by Pal (1978: 82) in reference to a Nepalese *paubha* in the possession of the Boston Museum of Fine Arts, which painting contains a great number of scenes from the *kinnarī* tale in its middle register: ‘There are two versions of this story in Buddhist literature, but the Newari rendering depicted in this *paubha* seems to be yet a third variation which has taken on much local colour’.

As with Borobudur and the Newar *paubha*, even with access to the three versions at hand we will still find ourselves at variance with some episodes projected in Jago’s reliefs. That we may in fact be dealing with a ‘localized’ adaptation will become abundantly clear when the scenes are considered one by one. For example, one sees that the action and venue of a scene can be resolved with the *avadāna* version, only to find that the actors appear to be at variance—or vice versa. The sequential ordering of some episodes within the reliefs also provides difficulties. It may be prudent to also bear in mind that given Jago’s emphasis on kingship, the story as illustrated in the reliefs may be a deliberate melding of specific episodes gathered from one or a number of sources, and chosen for inclusion on the shrine with more earthly motives in mind, as well as those of a spiritual and commemorative nature.

Making the task of dealing with the tale even more difficult, 2.7 metres of stonework containing an unknown number of the opening scenes are missing, with another small section near the end of the series showing signs of never having been finished, the stones being only partially carved. As well, the *beugel*—which, unlike the other narrative bands on Jago, carries no upper or lower decorative frieze or ogive bands—has lost the top course of its stones in a number of places so that identification of individual characters is frequently hampered by the loss of heads, headwear, facial features, etc. The natural erosion of time and climate together with geological disturbance and the more insidious and faster working effects of industrial pollution have also contributed to the damage.

Yet in spite of these obstacles, there are still enough key episodes left in situ to make comparison with the Sudhana–Manoharā tale a thoroughly worthwhile exercise. Additional help also comes in the strong, vertical relationship that exists between the narrative bands on Jago’s various terraces, by

which ‘like-themes’ are projected in vertical ‘parallels’ down through the reliefs on all wall facings.²¹ The relevance of these ‘parallels’ to the story will be indicated and briefly discussed during the scene-by-scene description and interpretation given below.

It should perhaps also be pointed out that discussion here will only deal with the tale on a scene-by-scene basis with a view to establishing identification. Any wider discussion of the tale from the point of view of its choice, location on the structure, its sequential position among the other narratives, etc., must be temporarily put aside, as also, regrettably, any detailed comparison with the Sudhana tale as it appears, say, on Borobudur. It is the sole aim here to initially establish a relationship between the specified reliefs on the *beugel* with the tale of Sudhana and Manoharā.

In interpreting the *beugel* reliefs, the *avadāna* (through Ralston’s translation) has been used as the primary source for three reasons: (1) within my current knowledge, it appears to contain most of the episodes depicted in the Jago reliefs, but more importantly its comprehensive telling of the tale

21. A quick perusal of Diag. 1 will reveal that there is no consistent point on Jago for the starting and stopping of relief narratives. This alone suggests that there is a fixed spatial order for the arrangement of narrative episodes and this is further supported by the fact that in some instances, a single episode may occupy an entire panel, while the very next panel (e.g., around a corner) may hold a number of episodes, all tightly condensed. This led me to the discovery that a system of vertical, parallel themes exists down each of the four sides. How these themes accurately and ingeniously express tenets of Vajrayāna is extensively explained in O’Brien 1993, esp. 261–79. Basically, the parallel themes relate to symbolism associated with the *maṇḍala* of the five Jina-Buddhas: Vairocana (centre), Akṣobhya (east), Ratnasambhava (south), Amitābha (west), and Amoghasiddhi (north). These five are the central divinities of the Diamond World *maṇḍala* but are also to be found in the central ‘palace’ of many other mandalas in Tantric Buddhism, including the mandala of Amoghapaśa Lokeśvara who is the central divinity of Jago.

A similar system relating to symbolism associated with the Jina-Buddhas is also found to be operating in the Old Javanese *kakavin Sutasoma*, a 14th-century literary work centring on Vairocana (O’Brien 2008). A potential link between composition of the *Sutasoma* and a possible 14th-century refurbishment of Jago is also considered therein (O’Brien 2008: 245–46) and again, from a different perspective, in a later essay (O’Brien 2011).

allows recognition of small details featured in the reliefs; (2) it features (as does the *Ṛddhiprabhāva* redaction) the *amoghapāśa*, which is the major attribute of the temple's central divinity, Amoghapāśa Lokeśvara; (3) Sudhanakumāra is also one of the four acolyte figures who frequently accompanies Amoghapāśa in his *maṇḍalas*, and who also figures as a member of the *cella* statuary of Jago.²²

Due to difficulties in describing and positively identifying some of Jago's more eroded and depleted bas-relief scenes, it will be necessary to supply a reasonably detailed summary of the *avadāna* tale, itself quite lengthy. In many cases, it is precisely the small details contained in the literary version that make identification possible.

THE SUDHANĀVADĀNA

The tale opens by relating of two kings in Pañcāla: one who ruled in the north, the other in the south.

22. According to Mukhopadhyay (1985: 124), Sudhanakumāra, an acolyte of Amoghapāśa, is held to be the same Sudhanakumāra of the *Gaṇḍavyūha Mahāyānasūtra*. Amoghapāśa himself is a Bodhisattva figure, the spiritual son of Amitābha. Mukhopadhyay also notes that Sudhanakumāra, during his search for enlightenment, is directed by the Bodhisattva Sāmantabhadra 'to approach Buddha Amitābha of the west from whom he learns the highest truth'. Iconographically, the acolyte Sudhanakumāra has a noble appearance, and his hands are held in *añjali-mudrā* with a book (of learning) under his left arm (Bhattacharyya 1958: 129). While any positive link between Prince Sudhana(-kumāra) of the *Kah-gyur* or Nepalese *avadānas* and Sudhanakumāra (son of a rich merchant) of the *Gaṇḍavyūha* is unknown to me, it is interesting to note that both the *avadāna* and *Gaṇḍavyūha* Sudhana tales appear on Borobudur; the *avadāna* being located on the lower register of reliefs on the main wall of the first terrace (actually the second terrace when counting the covered terrace) with the *Gaṇḍavyūha* story being the last of the narrative series on the upper galleries. One may also note a certain similarity in their separation on Jago, where the *avadāna* tale is also depicted on the second-from-lowest tier, with the statue of Sudhanakumāra highly likely to have resided in the temple's cella with Amoghapāśa. On the appearance of both Sudhanas on Borobudur, Fontein (1967: 170) remarks:

The appearance of a namesake of the person whom we may call the hero of the Barabudur in such an important place on the first gallery suggests the possibility that these two different persons may have had more in common than their names, at least in the eyes of the architects of the Barabudur.

King Dhana of North Pañcāla was a law-abiding monarch; his capital of Hastināpura was therefore prosperous and abundant, totally free of disorder, crime, and disease. In the city was a beautiful lake inhabited by the *nāga* Janmacitra, whose power over the rains caused the land to be fertile; the people, being well supplied, tended generously to the welfare of Buddhist monks (*śramaṇa*) and Brahmins, as well as the poor and needy.

The king of South Pañcāla, on the other hand, was negligent, cruel, and unjust. Because he did not rule in accordance with his *dharma*, the rains failed and eventually, out of fear and despair, the people ran away to North Pañcāla.

One day when the king of South Pañcāla was out inspecting his domains, he found the towns and villages deserted, the parks and temples fallen into decay. The reason, he was told, was the situation of peace and plenty in North Pañcāla due to the righteousness of its king and the presence of the *nāga* Janmacitra.

The king, heeding the opinions of his ministers, immediately promised to reform his ways on condition that the *nāga* could be brought to South Pañcāla. To that end, a snake charmer was hired and promised a basket of gold when the task was accomplished. The snake charmer surveyed the lake and ordered the preparation of utensils and offerings, guaranteeing to capture the *nāga* within seven days.

The *nāga*, noting the arrival and purpose of the snake charmer, feared great distress at being separated from his parents and thus approached a hunter who lived nearby. Since his own livelihood depended on the continued presence of Janmacitra in the lake, the hunter readily agreed to help him. The *nāga* explained that when the snake charmer performed his ritual, the waters would begin to seethe and at that point the *nāga* would be drawn to the surface. Before killing the snake charmer, the hunter must force him to reverse the spell; otherwise, the *nāga* would forever remain captive to the spell.

The *nāga* Janmacitra then 'took up his abode in a lonely spot [and] when seven days had passed, the hunter hid himself near that place' (Ralston 1906: 48). As the snake charmer proceeded with his ritual preparations, he was duly set upon by the

hunter in the manner prescribed by the *nāga*, and then killed. Now that the *nāga* had been released from the spell, 'he came forth from the lake' and in gratitude led the hunter to his abode to meet his parents. They in turn rewarded him with many precious jewels and gold.

Relating the incident to a gentle and kind *ṛṣi* who also lived near the lake, the hunter was admonished for having taken the jewels, etc. Instead, the *ṛṣi* advised him to ask for the 'amogha-chain' (Skt. *amoghapāśa*). At first the *nāgas* were reluctant to part with it, but as the debt was one of honour, they finally agreed.

The story then shifts to North Pañcāla... Now, the king and queen of North Pañcāla did not have a son and this was a great sadness for them. On the advice of the Buddhist monks, Brahmins, and others, King Dhana was exhorted to pray to the gods. He therefore prayed to Śiva, Varuṇa, Kubera, Vasudeva, and many others. In answer to his prayers 'a Bodhisat of the Bhadrakalpa entered into the womb of his good spouse' (Ralston 1906: 51). Being gifted and intuitive in such matters, the queen advised the king that she was expecting a son. The king was utterly delighted, his pleasure manifest in strings of pearls and other jewels with which he adorned her. No expense was spared to ensure the comfort of the queen during her pregnancy and at the end of the nine months, a son was born 'of noble form and lovely aspect, fair and gleaming, like unto gold in colour, with a head like a canopy, long arms, a brow of great width, interlacing eyebrows, a high-arched nose and provided with the full complement of limbs and joints' (Ralston 1906: 51). He was called Sudhana.

By the time the boy was grown up he was well schooled in reading and writing, 'adroit in his manners', and skilled in the five arts as was demanded by his status as a future *kṣatriya* king. King Dhana bestowed three palaces upon the young Sudhana, with a wife in each.

The tale switches back to the forest... where the hunter has learned of a beautiful lake nearby where, on the fifteenth day of each month, the beautiful *kinnarī* princess, Manoharā, attended by a great number of *kinnarī*, would come there to bathe. The hunter resolved to use the *amogha*-chain to capture Manoharā, which task he duly accomplished.

Since it would be most inappropriate for a mortal man to lay hands on a *kinnarī*, she offered her head jewel, the means of her power to fly and therefore escape, if he would promise not to touch her. Now, on that particular day, 'the youth Sudhana²³ had gone forth to the chase', during which he encountered the hunter with Manoharā. Realizing that very much more was to be gained by offering Manoharā as a gift, the hunter presented her to Sudhana. There follows a long discourse on the voluptuous nature of her physical charms. Sudhana was immediately besotted with her 'whose countenance was like unto the moon' and on returning to his palace installed her in the upper rooms and there spent all his time.

One day, two Brahmins came to Hāstinapura—one attaching himself to the king as *purohita*, the other to Sudhana. In order to secure his own position, the *purohita* devised a plot against Sudhana. An ongoing rebellion in the mountains gave the *purohita* his opportunity; he advised the king to send Sudhana as a test of his strength and courage. The king then summoned the youth who prepared to do his father's bidding. However, when Sudhana returned to his own palace to take leave of Manoharā, upon seeing her he immediately forgot the words of his father. The *purohita*, aware of this, advised the king to summon the troops to the ready, call upon the youth, and send him without further ado. This was arranged and the king summoned Sudhana again. Before leaving, Sudhana gave Manoharā's head jewel to his sympathetic mother with the request that it should be returned to Manoharā should any danger come to her during his absence.

23. In the *Kah-gyur avadāna* the youth of Sudhana is consistently emphasized (eg., Skt. *Sudhanakumāra*, *Sudhanarājakumāra*), which is also supported by the *Divyāvadāna* version. This is important as regards Jago, where the very youthful figure of Sudhana is never attired regally, with the possible exception of one problematic episode that could be interpreted as taking place in the *kinnarī* palace when Manoharā needed to regally dress Sudhana before presenting him to her father. This episode aside, Sudhana is consistently clothed quite simply in a *kain* that is tied and draped in the same manner throughout the reliefs. Apart from bracelets, he wears no other jewellery, save for one or possibly two episodes in which he wears an object around his neck.

With the aid of the *yakṣa* king Vaiśravaṇa and his mighty army, the mountain rebels were quickly intimidated into surrendering peacefully to Sudhana. In fact, the people avowed that they were not in rebellion against the king but the king's ministers. Being more than ready to accept the young and wise Sudhana, they opened the gates and went forth with full pomp to meet him.

At the palace... King Dhana asked the *purohita* to explain a fearful dream he had just experienced. Although the *purohita* knew the dream was a sign that Sudhana had won over the rebels, he instead told the king that it was a bad omen and that a very complicated rite must be held to combat it. Such a rite demanded that Manoharā be put to death. The king, swayed by the *purohita*, reluctantly agreed. However, Manoharā learned of the plan and went to the queen. The head jewel was returned to Manoharā and she was able to escape.

On her way back to the kingdom of her father, Manoharā recalled Sudhana's love for her and went to the *ṛṣi*. Knowing that Sudhana would also question him, Manoharā gave the *ṛṣi* her ring and a message for Sudhana should he wish to follow her. She warned that the journey was really far too arduous for a mortal as there were many dangerous obstacles to be overcome, but nevertheless left full instructions on how to deal with each—should he still be intent on making the journey.

The victorious Sudhana returned with his army from the mountains. After reporting to his father, he begged leave to return to his palace and there learned of Manoharā's departure. From his mother he heard details of the affair and he resolved to follow Manoharā. The *ṛṣi* reassured Sudhana concerning his future happiness and proceeded to pass on Manoharā's instructions. He told of the mountains, the fabulous animals and ogres with terrifying weapons and appearance, of the many strange rivers Sudhana would need to cross. The last two would be a river of snakes—the crossing of which would require a 'charm against snakes'—and a river of reeds, requiring 'the magic of sharp weapons struck together'. After crossing the last river, he would come to a land 'rich in bushes' where he would have to overcome the 500 *yakṣas* who dwelt there. There too he would find the capital of the *kinnarī* king (Ralston 1906: 70).

After gathering the recommended potions, remedies, and spells, Sudhana set out. In turn, he met and overcame all the obstacles as forewarned by the *ṛṣi* and eventually arrived at the *kinnarī* kingdom ruled by King Druma. As he stood gazing at the beautiful city, a number of *kinnarī* came to draw water. He asked them the purpose of all the water being drawn and was told that the princess Manoharā had recently returned, having escaped from mortal capture, and that now the smell of humanity had to be washed off her. As he conversed with them, Sudhana dropped Manoharā's ring into one of the jugs and instructed that it be the first to be poured.

As soon as she saw the ring, Manoharā realized that Sudhana had indeed come. She went to her father and after soothing his anger towards the youth, presented Sudhana in 'divine array'. Even though King Druma was much impressed by Sudhana and greatly desired him as son-in-law, he nevertheless set the youth several tasks to perform. After performing truly amazing feats with sword and arrow, Sudhana was set one more task by the king: he was required to pick Manoharā out from amid one thousand other beautiful *kinnarī* exactly like her. However, drawing on her love for him, Sudhana ordered that the real Manoharā present herself, with which command she readily complied.

King Druma could find no anger for this and instead summoned his people to pay great honour to Sudhana. The king happily agreed to the union of his beautiful daughter with Sudhana, although with a warning that he should never desert her. The happy couple sojourned in the *kinnarī* kingdom for some time, but Sudhana became increasingly distressed by the prolonged separation from his own parents and so begged leave of the king in order to take Manoharā back to the world of men. There was great rejoicing in Hāstinapura upon their arrival and the entry of the royal couple was a triumphant affair.

After receiving gifts of jewels from Sudhana and an account of his journey to the city of the *kinnarī*, King Dhana invested his son as king. For his part, Sudhana realized that his good fortune in acquiring Manoharā and the might of kingly power was the result of 'earlier deeds' and resolved to spend his reign bestowing gifts and practising good works.



Fig. 12.1b: The King of South Pañcāla goes out to inspect his domain. (Brandes ph. 102/103)

THE TALE OF SUDHANA ON CANDI JAGO

Following the description of each scene, an interpretation will be offered based for the most part, as noted earlier, on the Schiefner/Ralston translation of the *avadāna* as contained in the *Kah-gyur*. However, in a few instances of variance between the reliefs and the *avadāna*, I will also draw upon the *jātaka* version as related in the *Mahāvastu* for possible explanation and, in one interesting case, the Khotanese redaction.²⁴ Given the difficulties posed by damage and loss and resulting uncertainties, each interpretation will be followed by an analysis of the relationship between the relevant scene and those appearing in the narrative bands immediately above and below the *beugel*, bearing in mind the earlier mentioned system of ‘parallel themes’ operative on Jago which may well assist in any discussion of the subject matter of a scene. As an appendix to this work, I have also included a tabulated list of the scenes with an abbreviated summary of each.

SOUTHERN FACE

Scene 1

Reading from left to right, the first scene of the Sudhana tale (Fig. 1.1b) is separated from the last scene of the previous tale (*Kuñjarakarna*) by a triangular floral motif followed by what appears to be a banana palm. Beside the palm, stands a corpulent male figure dressed in royal garb. His damaged face looks towards the remainder of this

long scene, which is a highly ordered landscape, perhaps a formal garden or a park. The sequence of two different tree types with constructed surrounds is repeated three times in the remaining stonework. No other figures are visible and it is unknown how far this scene may have extended—the rest of the panel along to the southeast corner of the shrine (2.7 metres) is missing, as is a shorter distance around the corner on the eastern face.

Interpretation: In terms of the *avadāna* tale, this scene likely depicts the king of South Pañcāla as he goes out to inspect his domains and finds them deserted. Perhaps in scenes on the now-missing section, we might have seen him discussing the desertion of his people with his ministers, promising to reform if they will return. We might have also seen some reference to the rain-bringing *nāga* who resided in North Pañcāla and to the snake charmer being dispatched to snare the *nāga* and bring it to South Pañcāla. While we can only speculate on missing episodes, could it be mere coincidence that the start of the tale showing the ruler and kingdom of South Pañcāla is depicted on Jago’s southern face?

Parallel themes: Parallels for this scene are provided on the temple by stories above (*Pārthayajña*, second terrace), and below (*Aji Dharma*, first terrace). Whereas at this point on the *beugel* the bad king of South Pañcāla finds himself ruler of a kingdom bereft of its populace, Yudhiṣṭhira (directly above), through a foolish act, has a kingdom of people of which he is no longer ruler. Directly below on the first terrace, Aji Dharma is similarly kingdomless through self-imposed exile.²⁵

24. It should be noted that while the *Mahāvastujātaka* does occasionally provide quite a plausible interpretation for some puzzling scenes, it does not feature the *amoghapāśa* at all—the hunter trapped Manohāra by means of a spell.

25. According to the well-known episode from the Tantri tales, King Aji Dharma has left his kingdom to wander in



Fig. 12.2: King and queen of North Pāñcala (?). (Brandes ph. 101/100)



Fig. 12.2a: Detail. (Brandes ph. 101)

SOUTHERN FACE

Scene 2

As can be seen better in Fig. 2a (detail), there are actually three figures in this early photo by Brandes. Only the lower limbs are visible on the figure at far left. Given that it is separated from the two figures shown by a small vegetal motif, it is conceivable that the first figure may have belonged to a prior scene that has now disappeared. The stance of the feet, however, indicates that it is faced in the same direction as the second figure.

Of the two main figures, one is certainly female; the other, male and somewhat paunchy. Though the upper portion of his head is missing, the lower half of the face seems rather gross and *rākṣasa*-like. His adornments suggest a royal figure, a king. The headless female figure has her left hand on the shoulder of the male. Her right hand, at chest height, appears to be holding something small. The male's right arm is outstretched, his hand behind her back or around her waist. His left hand seems to grasp his paunch. The couple appear to be in 'inhabited' space—perhaps a palace. To the right of the 'king' there is a highly stylized tree in a *kurūṇan*,²⁶ followed by a wall and gateway.

object remorse for having allowed his wife (Satyavati) to commit suicide. Added to this, the kingdom is now without its most valuable asset, the queen. At this point in the Aji Dharma story, Jago's episodes begin to deviate from other known versions. Aji Dharma, unable to fill the void in his life with any other woman, abandons his kingdom but then encounters Ambaravati, the daughter of an ascetic. She is the image of Satyavati and Aji Dharma perceives her to be the reincarnation of his lost love. However, her father is violently opposed to this match (Soetrismo 1985: 1–19).

26. A *kurūṇan* appears to be a constructed, formal surround for a tree. In his discussion of the *Kuṇḍarakarṇa* reliefs of Candi Jago, Bernet Kempers remarks that this particular tree motif (of which there seems to be at least two different types) 'indicates that the action takes place in heaven [while] the last one in a series of such trees at the same time marks the end of the scene in

Interpretation: Through steadfast performance of appropriate rites, the king and queen of North Pañcāla have finally been blessed with a child who will be a 'Bodhisat of the Bhadrakalpa'. When the queen tells the king that she knows she is expecting a son, 'the king joyfully drew himself up, and stretched out his right arm and said, "I shall behold the son whom I have long been desiring".... Thus did he joyfully exclaim' (Ralston 1906: 51). Apart from the fact that in the Jago scene a kingly figure plainly extends his right arm to a female figure, perhaps we can also gauge a little of his 'joy' in the posture of his left hand as he clasps his paunch.

In further explanation of this scene, the story goes on to relate that throughout the queen's pregnancy the king pampered her with special measures to preserve her comfort in times of heat and cold and she was given special foods, etc. 'With strings of pearls of various kinds and with other ornaments he adorned the body of his wife' (Ralston 1906: 51–52). That we should find a queen bejewelled so on Jago would not be unique, but could it be suggested that the small item held by her is perhaps a ring or a jewel with which the king has demonstrated his pleasure at her condition?

Parallel themes: The pregnancy aspect is well suited for placement on the eastern face of the shrine, where we find episodes on all levels very much concerned with aspects of femininity and feminine behaviour. These will become obvious as the scenes unfold. Here, in the Sudhana tale, the emphasis that is placed on producing a son underlines one of the most important roles of a queen.

Scene 3

Three figures occupy the scene in Fig. 12.3, which is separated from the next by a bountiful tree

heaven' (as cited in A. Teeuw and S. Robson 1981: 208). Notably on Jago, this particular type of tree with *kurunān* motif seems only to appear on the first terrace and the *beugel*. It does not seem to have been used at all on the second and third terraces or the *cella* where other 'heavenly' locales might have prompted its use. On the other hand, if the monument was refurbished and/or modified in the 14th century—which could well explain the odd nature of the *beugel* in the overall design—it may also account for the inclusion of variations from those employed in the 13th century when the temple was originally commissioned.

(see Fig. 12.3a). The absence of stones on the top row causes some problems with the first figure, but from his corpulence and dress, it could be the same royal figure from the previous scene. The second figure is obviously female but, if it is the same woman from the previous scene, then she seems older.

These two figures face a young male figure seated in a respectful pose before them. This latter figure has sustained some damage to the face, but we can see that his hair is wavy, his eyebrows meet over his nose, and his dress seems to consist of a *kain*, rolled and tied at the waist. There are a number of curling motifs around the seated figure.²⁷ The three figures in this scene are separated from the next scene by a tree with luxuriant foliage—its lower branches, laden with fruit, dip to the ground (see detail, Fig. 12.3a). This particular tree motif is the only one of its kind on Jago.



Fig. 12.3: The king and queen of North Pañcāla with their son, Sudhana (?). (Brandes ph. 100/99)

27. On Jago, 'curling flame motifs' near a character would seem to most often indicate divine or magical status.



Fig. 12.3a: Detail of anthropomorphic tree. (Brandes ph. 99)

Interpretation: Scene 3 presumably depicts the king and queen of North Pañcāla some years later. Although the facial features, like the others in this scene, are badly damaged, the smaller figure who sits in attitude of obeisance would be none other than Sudhana as a youth. The submissive nature of this character is constant throughout the series, and together with specific features and dress, makes it consistently recognizable as being one and the same. The *avadāna* relates that among other qualities, he was ‘adroit in his manners’. Here, the posture suggests compliancy towards his parents. The *avadāna* describes Sudhana as having ‘a head like a canopy, long arms, a brow of great width, interlacing eyebrows, a high-arched nose, etc.’ and while these features are damaged here, they can easily be recognized in later illustrations such as Figs. 12.6 and 12.11a. From the *avadāna* we also learn that when Sudhana came of age and was skilled in the arts and qualities of a future king, the king bestowed three palaces upon the youth, with a wife in each.

Returning to Fig. 12.3 (main illustration), it might be suggested that the left hand of the female figure seems to be holding something small, delicately poised between thumb and forefinger. Something this small could conceivably be a ring or a gem—might it have some connection with the gift of the previous scene? Or is this the presentation of the palaces? In any event it would seem to be the royal female who dominates the scene, with the king standing behind her.

As regards the fruiting tree, its shape is distinctly anthropomorphic, clearly suggesting feminine form and grace—the four upper limbs rather like a four-armed goddess. Its fluid, curving form and gracefully weeping branches, heavy with fruit, may well be signifying the abundance of the capital of North Pañcāla, Hāstinapura. In *kakavin* literature, the motif of a tree whose laden branches hang down to the ground is frequently employed to indicate fertility and abundance in a landscape. Fertility and abundance are also primary attributes of a queen. The tree also serves here as a most unique scene divider—a function to which we will return shortly.

Although thus far the *jātaka* version from the *Mahāvastu* has contributed little to the interpretation of the Jago scenes, at this point the *jātaka* does relate that having come of age, Sudhanu (= Sudhana) was invested as ruler on the retirement of his father. It also mentions among the many virtues of Sudhanu, that he was ‘accomplished and dutiful to his mother and father’ (Jones 1952: 92).

Scene 4

The stance of the larger figure—right hand on hip, left hand raised with first and middle fingers extended—suggests an attitude of directive. The young male looks towards the larger figure with head slightly bowed (Fig. 12.4a, detail). His right hand is raised and held flat, palm against his left breast and upper forearm, the fingers spread into two groups. This interesting posture suggests allegiance or obedience to a command with the feet turned away from the regal figure, as if leaving to carry out an order. Again there is damage to the face, but enough is left of the dress to suggest that it is the same young figure from the earlier scene. There will be seen to be a consistency in the dress—par-



Fig. 12.4: A corpulent, bejewelled *rākṣasa*/*yakṣa* figure addresses the young male. (Brandes ph. 99/98)



Fig. 12.4a: Detail. (Photo: author)

ticularly in the tying of the *kain*—that like the facial features, will also carry through ensuing scenes. The figures are framed on the leading (left) side by the aforementioned anthropomorphic tree—which would appear by its ‘stance’ to be ‘concerned’ with the current scene rather than the former—and on the far (right) side by vegetal and rock motifs. There are a number of curling flame motifs near the young male (at his far side) with no such motifs apparent near the thickset figure; indeed, it is the anthropomorphic tree which seems to attend him. A circular type of motif separates the two figures at head level; whether it has some special meaning is difficult to say as similar motifs appear throughout the series.

In the lower right-hand corner of the same scene, there is a series of water motifs in which the head of some sort of horned aquatic creature appears to emerge from the waves. Above this creature there are motifs that seem to represent rocks and vegetation. These also continue into the next scene. What ties the aquatic creature to the current scene and not the following one is the fact that it faces back towards the two figures previously described.²⁸

Interpretation: Precisely what is being acted out in this scene is somewhat difficult to establish from

28. In his description of this particular relief, Brandes (1904: 55) refers to the creature as *een dier* (‘an animal’) with no further comment.

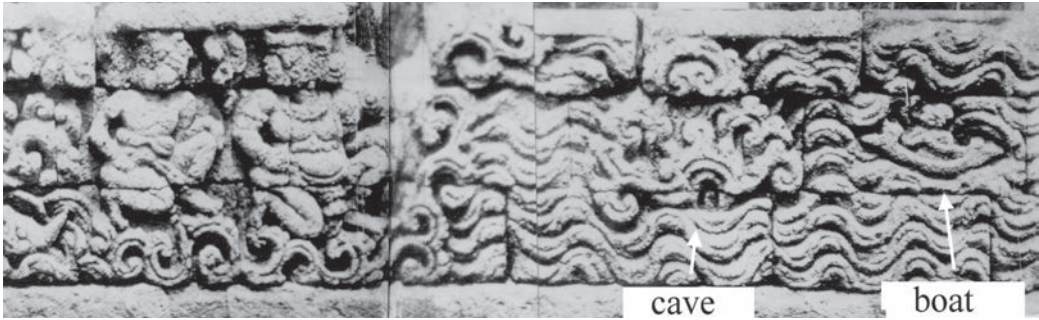


Fig. 12.5: At the lake of Janmacitra. (Brandes phs. 98 and 97)

the *avadāna*. The youthful figure shares many similarities with the earlier figure proposed as Sudhana, although there may be a suggestion here of Sudhana being slightly older. Given the similarity with the rotund figure in Figs. 12.2 and 12.2a, it could be suggested that the corpulent figure here is the king of North Pañcāla (Sudhana's father); however, this presents difficulties later in Scene 9 where the royal figure can also be taken contextually to be King Dhana but where his appearance is much slimmer.

An alternative explanation, also to be found in the *avadāna*, is that when the *nāga*, Janmacitra, learned of the plot to send a snake charmer to capture him, he assumed the form of a man and went to the hunter, Phalaka, who lived nearby in order to elicit his help. A plan was devised to kill the snake charmer by the lake.

Connected to the same idea is the possibility that it is the king of South Pañcāla commissioning the snake charmer to abduct the *nāga*, who gains warning by apparently overhearing (?) them. Is the horned creature performing the role of listening to the previous two figures?

This is surely a scene where the venue of Janmacitra is being introduced, but as yet we have no certainty as to the actors.

Parallel themes: Unfortunately, in this instance, there seems little help to be gleaned from parallel scenes either above or below. In the *Pārthayajña* scene immediately above, Arjuna encounters two pairs of courting couples in the forest, which is followed by the first views of Mahāyāni's hermitage. Since the incident of the courting couples is not related in the *Pārthayajña kakavin*, we are left to guess its content and

meaning on the temple.²⁹ In the *Aji Dharma* story on the tier below, there is the 'demonic' form of Ambaravati's father as he faces the fatal arrow from Aji Dharma's bow,³⁰ and to a certain extent, this echoes the action against the snake charmer in the *Sudhana* tale, although not shown in the reliefs.

Scene 5

This scene (Fig. 12.5) is the longest and most prominent on the eastern face of the *beugel*. On the left half are two figures in similar crouching positions among rock motifs at the edge of an expanse of water motifs (continued out of range of this photograph). Although both figures have sustained considerable damage to their faces, the one on the right appears to have some form of headdress with jewellery comparable to the 'royal' figure in the previous scene and probably again in Scene 6 (Fig. 12.6). The attributes of the left-hand figure are too marred to be recognizable but his *kain* may also be similar to that of the youth in Fig. 12.4a. The head of the larger figure appears to be turned back towards his slender companion as if the two are in conversation.³¹

29. Arjuna has just undertaken a quest to regain the kingdom for his brother, Yudhiṣṭhira. In order to prepare himself physically and mentally as well as gain the favour of the gods, he has taken an oath of penance and chastity. On the eastern wall the sight of courting couples is his first temptation, but not his last. On the far end of the same face he will brush aside the attempted seduction by a nun.

30. For the *Pārthayajña* scene, see Brandes ph. 149/148 and for the *Aji Dharma* scene, see Brandes ph. 43/42.

31. Interestingly, the crouching posture of these two figures is very like that of figures elsewhere on Jago depicted

In the centre of the water motifs there is a large conical-shape 'pile' of rock motifs. At the centre of its base, one of the rock motifs has the appearance of an arched cavern with a tiny figure of indeterminate form inside. This rocky 'cavern' marks near enough the centre of the eastern face of the *beugel*.³²

To the right of the 'cavern' is a small boat containing a single figure. Seen in detail (Fig. 12.5a), the head in profile is strangely shaped with quite definitely bulging eye(s). Part of the odd shape of the head could be due to some form of head covering. The hands are held, seemingly clasped together. Wave motifs surround the craft, both above and below. This scene is separated by vegetation and rock motifs from the next scene.

Interpretation: According to the story, Janmacitra 'then took up his abode in a lonely spot' and the hunter took up a position 'near that place'. In the Jago scene, neither of the two crouching figures appears to be armed with a bow and arrow as related in the *avadāna*. The similarity between these two figures and those of the preceding scene and following scene has already been noted. Brandes (1904: 55) suggested that the larger figure with the crown and assorted jewellery is a '*reuzenkonink*' ('*rākṣasa* king'), with teeth showing as if laughing.³³ The smaller figure he described as a servant '*boeta*'—a being of a lower class of demon (*bhūta*).

If the identities of the two crouching figures are ambiguous, so too is the figure in the boat. Contextually, it is the *nāga*. The water motifs do seem disturbed in nature as described in the tale.³⁴ Of



Fig. 12.5a: Detail. (Photo: author)

interest, Brandes (1904: 55) describes the boat as '*een naga-vormig schuitje, met een beeldje er in*' ('a small, *nāga*-shaped boat with a tiny figure in it'). However, if it is the *nāga*, Janmacitra, where is the royal regalia of the previous scenes? Is it then the hunter on his way to the abode of the *nāga*'s parents where he is to be rewarded? Another possibility, albeit remote, is that in some form of localized adaptation, the figure involved in this whole episode is not a hunter but Sudhana himself.³⁵

as flying (see, e.g., Fig. 12.14, Scene 14); see also Brandes phs. 40 and 187. Notably, however, the flying figures are accompanied by a fluttering ribbon-like motif, distinctly different to the rock motifs of the current scene.

32. In the *Pārthayajña* above, the centre of the main panel is marked by a thirteen-storey pagoda-like (*meru*) structure in Mahāyāni's hermitage (Brandes ph. 148/147). Below, on the first terrace (*Aji Dharma*), it is the liberated 'good' character of the demon ascetic that marks the centre (Brandes ph. 42/41).

33. I thought the figure a little too damaged, at least in the photo, to be sure about the 'laughing'.

34. '...when, as he is performing a ceremony of this kind, the waters of the lake begin to seethe and overflow, and I come forth from them': see the summary of the tale as given above.

35. Andrea Aciri (personal communication) has raised the possibility that the head of the figure in the boat could be bird-like and that with its beak-like nose and bulging eye it may well represent a *garuḍa* figure. As the archenemy of snakes, its aid is frequently invoked in spells aimed at the healing of snakebite, etc. While none of the versions of the tale in my possession give any detail of mantras or spells used by the snake charmer, this does not preclude the possibility that a Javanese version may well have featured a *garuḍa* spell, given the popularity of the bird in Javanese and Balinese art and literature.

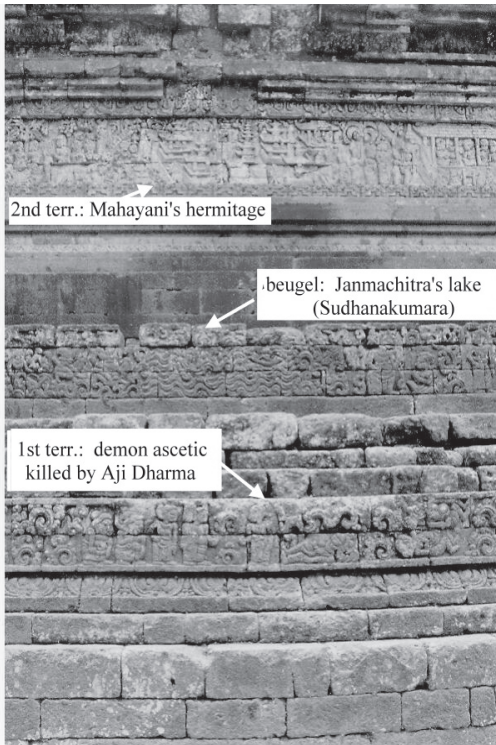


Fig. 12.5b: Section of *beugel*, second and third terraces on eastern face. (Photo: author)

As with the previous scene, the venue can be resolved according to the story, but not the participants.

The notable absence in this episode in the reliefs is the slaying of the snake charmer; however, the parallel scene directly below on the first terrace may assist.

Parallel themes: At this point, mid-centre of Jago's eastern face, the scenes on the other levels above and below those of the Sudhana tale become quite important (see Fig. 12.5b). For example, in the tale on the first terrace below, Aji Dharma (out of sight to the left) has killed the demon ascetic with his bow and arrow, along with the demon's two accomplices. The three lie dead, directly below the lake scene on the *beugel*.

As noted, at this juncture in the Sudhana *avadāna*, the hunter kills the snake charmer although neither of the crouching figures appears to be armed. If it is Sudhana, a Bodhisattva, who is in league with Janmacitra or has been charged

with guarding the *nāga*, it would not be in order for him to be involved in a killing, and perhaps this situation has been resolved here by suggested reference to the story below where a 'killing' actually has taken place.

If we accept that the lake and cavern scene is the domain of Janmacitra into which Sudhana has, or is about to enter, then it is closely paralleled above on the second terrace where, in a scene to the right of Mahāyāni's hermitage, we see Arjuna being ushered into Mahāyāni's *bale*.³⁶

Scene 6

The first thing to be noted about this scene (Fig. 12.6) is that it is clearly not taking place within the boundaries of formalized space (ie., no gates or structures). 'Rocks' and a tree separate the two figures beside the lake in the previous scene, with similar motifs forming a divide between this and the ensuing scene. Fig. 12.6a shows the two figures in detail. The one to the left is paunchy and regally garbed. His left hand (much less damaged and more obvious in Fig. 12.6) is extended towards the second figure—whether it is just a raised finger or whether the hand once held something is unclear. The second figure is that of a young male seated on the ground in a very respectful posture, hands held in obeisance. When examining this relief in situ, I noted that these hands, although damaged, may also once have held something which protruded from underneath. In Brandes ph. 95 there is the suggestion of perhaps a chain or string of beads running over the outside of the hand—but it is difficult to be certain.

It was earlier suggested that the headgear or crown on the larger of these two figures might be similar to that worn by a similar figure in Fig. 12.5, while the seated figure is very similar to the young male in an identical pose in Fig. 12.3 and very likely the same as in Fig. 12.4. Each of these representations of the youth is accompanied by a curling motif. In Fig. 12.5 a curling motif is set

36. While there is considerable difficulty with the Janmacitra scene on Jago, it is perhaps worth noting that Krom (1927: 251) also had similar problems with the same episode as depicted on Borobudur.



Fig. 12.6: Sudhana receives the *amogha*-chain? (Brandes ph. 96)



Fig. 12.6a: Detail. (Photo: author)

between the two crouching figures, a further indication that it is the same youth as in Figs. 12.3 and 12.4. As for the curling motifs present in the current scene, although ubiquitous in the scenes pertaining

to this tale on Jago—particularly those involving Sudhana—here, both figures are attended by them.

Interpretation: We know from the source tale that the hunter was rewarded by the *nāgas* with the



Fig. 12.7: Sudhana (circled). (Photo: author; cf. Brandes phs. 96, 95)

amoghapāśa and we might surmise that the Jago scene portrays the bestowing of the gift—perhaps with variant characters. It is interesting that while the *avadāna* does not appear to ascribe royal status to Janmacitra or his parents, when Krom wrote of the same episode on the Borobudur version using the *Divyāvadāna* as the source tale, he identified the parents of Janmacitra as the *nāga* king and queen. Looking at the elaborate headgear on the ‘royal’ figure in this scene, we can see serpent-like scrolls at the back of it.³⁷ This scene may then be rendering a grateful *nāga* ‘king’ as he presents the *amogha*-chain to the saviour of his son—but here on Jago the recipient appears to be Sudhana. It may well be that in these episodes on Jago, the youthful figure has been Sudhana all along.

Parallel themes: If it is counsel that Sudhana is receiving (along with the *amogha*-chain?) from the *nāga* king, then it is paralleled above in the *Pārthayajña* reliefs where Arjuna is receiving counsel from Mahāyāni on the true nature of existence and the evil power of *rajas* and *tamas*, which must be overcome (Zoetmulder 1974: 369). Arjuna will shortly have cause to put this advice to good use. As for the *amogha*-chain on the *beugel*, it came to be used in the capture of Manoharā.

Scene 7

The lone figure (circled) in this scene (Fig. 12.7) is once again that of the young male. He walks in the direction of the narrative reliefs but looks back over his shoulder to the two figures in the previous scene. Clearly visible on this figure is the presence of a decorative item worn around the neck, extending out to the shoulders. While such an item being worn is not apparent in the previous scene, here, bead shapes on the chest and shoulder are quite clear. The youthful figure is separated from the ensuing scene to the right by a highly stylized tree motif (without *kurūṇan*); notably, he is without the curling motif.

Interpretation: Here, a young male journeys on, alone. He looks back however, as if to the previous scene. Possibly this is a device to portray recollection (of received counsel). According to the story, on the day that Sudhana acquired Manoharā, the *kinnarī* princess, he had gone ‘forth to the chase’, and the next scene may actually depict the first meeting of the couple. As for the item around the figure’s neck, could this be the *amoghapāśa* itself?³⁸

Regarding the tree motif, whether we understand it as a ‘tree of heaven’ (*pārijāta*) may be open to question but there is no doubt that its placement

37. Brandes (1904: 55) describes the figure as a ‘*boeta-vorst* (?) of titan, met makoṭa (kroon) en wild naar achten krullende lokken’ (‘a demon king (?) or giant, with crown and unruly hair curling at the back’).

38. In later scenes, Sudhana will again be shown wearing certain items of significance—perhaps an artistic device to convey that he has such items in his possession.



Fig. 12.8: Sudhana meets Manoharā (?). (Brandes phs. 95, 94)

here, in lieu of rock or vegetal motifs, clearly has meaning. Like the earlier fruit-laden tree, this is a special scene divider, marking either the entry or exit point of an extraordinary area. Perhaps it serves to mark the end of the special area through which Sudhana has passed: the kingdom of North Pañcāla and the cave-realm of the *nāgas*. This being the case, the fruiting tree may have marked the entry point and this in itself is significant since we are told that the fertility and abundance of North Pañcāla were entirely due to the presence of the *nāga* Janmacitra who lived in its lake and who held the power over rain.

Parallel themes: The parallel that occurs here with the *Pārthayajña* scene above is both subtle and interesting. As noted, Sudhana is looking back as he journeys, as if in reflection on the advice or instruction he has just received. In a scene almost directly above, Arjuna is sitting alone in his *bale*, having retired for the night. The story relates that at this time Arjuna is beset by problems with his own desires but that Mahāyāni's advice brings calm to his mind as he reflects on her words (Zoetmulder 1974: 369). In this scene, Arjuna sits in his *bale* also facing the previous scene (Brandes ph. 146).

The stylized tree separating the journeying Sudhana from the next scene is also paralleled below on the first terrace where, according to the available version of the *Aji Dharma*, the Brahman accompanies the 'liberated' ascetic (shown as flying) to the realm of Vairocana (see Brandes ph. 40).

Scene 8

This illustration includes part of the previous scene (Sudhana and *parijāta* tree) to demonstrate continuity in the image of the young man. The action in Scene 8 (Fig. 12.8) appears to be taking place outside a walled compound, the enclosing fence and gateway acting as a scene divider. There are four figures taking part. The young male (some damage) to the left faces another slender, somewhat regally dressed figure (slightly less damaged). The regal figure wears a headdress featuring a backward curling diadem at the front and what might be a 'lobster-claw' at the back (see detail in Fig. 12.8a). The vestiges of a bosom in the Brandes photo suggest that this figure is female. To the rear of this 'regal' person stand two *panakawan*-like figures.



Fig. 12.8a: Sudhana and Manoharā. (Photo: author)



Fig. 12.8b: Statue of a 'royal' *kinnarī* in Mojokerto Museum, East Java. (Photo: author)

In the top register, a curling motif separates the two main figures, while at 'ground level' there is a floral motif.

Interpretation: As related in the *avadāna*, while Sudhana was out on a chase he encountered a hunter who had used the *amoghapāśa* given to him by the *nāga* to capture Manoharā as she bathed at a lake. The hunter had then presented Manoharā to Sudhana, who was immediately captivated by her charms—on which the story dwells at some length. That this scene shows the hunter is unlikely; the first figure to the left—in spite of its deterioration—is much closer to that of our Sudhana. The second figure is regally attired with jewellery and ornate headdress. Moreover, there is no sign of obeisance between these two: they clearly meet as equals. It would appear that because it is Sudhana himself who has acquired the *amogha*-chain (the beaded item is still apparent in this scene), it is he who has also met or captured Manoharā.

If the second figure is Manoharā, then the headdress as described would not be out of keeping with her status as a princess.³⁹ The eyes on this particular figure were very well defined and a comparison with those of the female in the next scene revealed them to be very similar in shape. We are also told that she surrendered her head jewel (the means of her ability to fly) to her captor. Perhaps it is her head jewel that she is here offering to Sudhana.

As an alternative explanation, the Jago scene of Fig. 8a and the next scene (Fig. 12.9) might refer to an incident related in the *Mahāvastu* (*jātaka*) version of the Sudhana tale. In the *Mahāvastu* episode, Prince Sudhanu (= Sudhana) is sent by his father to attend a grand sacrificial rite being held in a neighbouring kingdom. Among the creatures in the sacrificial enclosure is the beautiful *kinnarī*, Manoharā. When Sudhanu sees her, he falls in love with her and she with him. He persuades the king to abandon his planned sacrifice and hold a 'blameless' rite instead. Sudhanu then returns with his

39. Although having no discernible connection with Jago, the Museum of Antiquities in Mojokerto, East Java, has in its collection a largish statue of a *kinnarī* displaying distinctly royal embellishments (Fig. 8b). Her crown (a little damaged) appears to have been of the same style as that of the royal figure in the Jago scene, though perhaps not so exaggerated in height. Enquiries at the Museum revealed that the exact provenance of the statue was not known, other than that it was 'from the area' and the dating: 'around Majapahit'.



Fig. 12.8c: Detail showing Panakawan figures.
(Brandes ph. 94)

beautiful *kinnarī* to his own kingdom, where he sets up court solely with her.

The introduction of *panakawan* (Fig. 12.8c) at this point in the story is intriguing. In a discussion of the *Aji Dharma* reliefs on the first terrace of Jago, Hunter (2000: 75, 81) notes the presence of two distinct sets of *panakawan* figures who seem to bear a strong resemblance to current-day ‘left’ and ‘right’ *panakawan* figures appearing in Javanese and Balinese wayang performances.

The Sudhana-Manoharā *panakawan* are obviously of a similar class of figures as those in the *Aji Dharma* reliefs, but the now deteriorated state of the carvings makes it impossible to say that they are the same characters. They may well be attendants of Sudhana or even Manoharā, in much the same way as Arjuna is attended by *panakawan* on the second terrace.

Parallel themes: The wall and gateway that act as a scene divider in this *Sudhana* relief are also employed below in the *Aji Dharma* tale on the first terrace. Here, according to the available version, we find that the Brahman and ascetic have arrived outside Vairocana’s heaven, where ostensibly the ascetic will receive instruction and salvation.⁴⁰ In

the *Pārthayajña* reliefs above, a nun is slipping away from a *bale* in which other nuns are still asleep, in order to go to Arjuna (Brandes ph. 144). The *Pārthayajña* scene provides an interesting interplay with the Sudhana tale. Whereas the nun steals away voluntarily from her companions in an attempt to seduce Arjuna, who rejects her in accordance with his ascetic aspirations, Manoharā has, by her capture, been isolated from her female companions against her will. In the *avadāna*, Manoharā must reject the possible (and inappropriate) attentions of the hunter, but then—as we may presume from the next scene has also happened on Jago—she takes up with Sudhana, the equality of their regal status being closer and a union therefore more appropriate.⁴¹

Scene 9

This scene (Fig. 12.9) is quite obviously set within a compound, bordered by a sloping wall with a gate at the front (left) and a similar wall without a gate to the rear (right). Five persons are involved in the scene: the first is the young male who stands in respectful posture before another figure whose crown suggests that he is a king. There is some damage, but the second figure appears either to be holding something or to show his right hand in a gesture of instruction (with index finger raised), his left arm by his side (see detail, Fig. 12.9a). Reclining in the *bale* is a young, voluptuous female. Her long hair falls down behind her shoulders as she leans back, head turned away as though in grief, not wanting to hear the words of the king (see Fig. 12.9b).⁴² The rear wall of the compound divides this scene from

41. On the third terrace above (*Arjunavivāha*), the parallel panel has disappeared. However, the storyline up to this point in the reliefs suggests that we might have seen the celestial nymph Suprabhā feigning to offer herself to the demon king Nivātakavaca in order to lure him into revealing the secret of his great power. Indra, who had devised the plan himself, also ordered that Arjuna should accompany and protect the nymph. On no account was she to suffer violation at the hands of the demon.

42. A less likely alternative is that she is involved in the conversation of the two *panakawan* figures seated outside the *bale* behind her. Whether these two *panakawan* are the same as those of the previous scene is difficult to say. It would seem logical, but they are just too damaged to be absolutely certain.

40. Hunter (2000: 87). The gateway in the *Aji Dharma* tale seems of a different design to that depicted in the series above, being more of the split variety (Brandes ph. 40).



Fig. 12.9: Sudhana's palace quarters. (Brandes phs. 94, 93, 92)



Fig. 12.9a: Royal figure. (Detail of Brandes ph. 93)



Fig. 12.9b: Manoharā. (Detail of Brandes ph. 93)

the next, which shows a figure in a forest setting walking away from the compound.

Interpretation: The charms of Manoharā as related in the *avadāna* are too vividly portrayed in this scene for us to consider any other identity for the female in the *bale*. Indeed, this female form is far more voluptuous than any other (extant) on the shrine. She is also quite clearly without the elaborate crown of the previous scene. If we continue to follow the *avadāna*, there seems little doubt that this scene depicts Sudhana's father, King Dhana, counselling his son on his obligations to the kingdom (regarding the rebellion, etc.) and ordering him to put aside Manoharā. However, this perhaps raises difficulties when we look at the difference in features and build between this kingly 'father' and the one given similar identification in Fig. 12.2 (detail Fig. 12.2a).

Parallel themes: If the first alternative is true, that this scene portrays Sudhana's father ordering the young prince to put aside Manoharā in favour of royal duties, then there is a very clear parallel directly above in the *Pārthayajña* reliefs where Arjuna is also lecturing the besotted nun on her duties. Directly below (*Aji Dharma*), the parallel may be more one of contrast. Vairocana is said to be counselling the ascetic father (accompanied by the Brahman). According to the version of the story at hand, the *ṛṣi* had wanted to take his daughter, Ambaravatī, away from Aji Dharma. Vairocana tells him that Ambaravatī is really the incarnation of Queen Satyavatī, Aji Dharma's late wife, and that the two should be allowed to live in peace.

Scene 10

Outside the palace, a solitary person of slim build proceeds alone, looking ahead (Fig. 12.10). Separated from the previous scene by a compound wall, the figure is surrounded by vegetal motifs and rock scrolls. Here ends the eastern panel of the *beugel* band.

Interpretation: The figure has suffered deterioration to the extent that it is difficult to decide whether it is male or female. On the one hand it could be the young Sudhana figure who now journeys in a forest setting or, as seems more likely contextually, it is Manoharā fleeing the palace in fear of



Fig. 12.10: Manoharā (or Sudhana?). (Detail of Brandes ph.92)

court conspiracies and plotting.⁴³ The *avadāna* relates that although the young prince agreed to his father's summons to duty, he quickly forgot when back in Manoharā's company and it was then necessary to summon him to the court. However, while the next scene (Fig. 12.11) seems to be taking place in a palace environment, some of the figures are ambiguous. The first two figures are priestly and, given the context of the story, their appearance at this point would not necessarily be unexpected.

Parallel themes: Above, in the last scene of the *Pārthayajña* reliefs on the eastern face, Arjuna is shown alone at his ablutions before leaving the convent to continue his journey (Brandes ph. 143). Below, in the last scene of the *Aji Dharma* tale, the available account relates that Aji Dharma

43. Looking ahead to Scene 18 (Fig. 12.18, detail), it will be seen that the Manoharā figure holds the left arm in a very similar position.

and the *panakawan*, led by Ambaravatī (formerly Satyavati), are entering a compound, there to live happily ever after. However, it could also be suggested that Ambaravatī is about to enter the compound (perhaps a convent?) alone and that her gesture back towards Aji Dharma is one of farewell (Brandes ph. 37).

Summary of the Eastern Wall

The stories carved on Jago display in their upward progression a rise in the power and righteous behaviour of kings that increasingly will depend on the principles of esoteric practices. With attainment of the right queen being an essential attribute of ideal kingship, the activities of women as leading players in the lives of kings, kings-to-be, and would-be kings are clearly evident on the eastern face of the temple as a whole. For example, at the southern end of the eastern face of the third terrace that features the *Arjunavivāha*, we see a scene totally devoted to the celestial nymphs in Indra's heaven (Brandes ph. 184/183). Although the ensuing panels are missing, from the context of the *kakavin* tale, we can surmise that they would have shown the nymph Suprabha bravely carrying out her dangerous mission against the demon king Nivātakavaca on behalf of Indra, King of the Gods; while at the same time gently rebuffing her protector and companion, Prince Arjuna, whose amorous advances might well have distracted her from her task. Had she not been successful, heaven and earth would surely have been destroyed by the demon.

Next, in the *Pārthayajña* on the second terrace, the eastern panels begin with a scene showing Arjuna in tears. Having left his distressed wife and mother, he thinks of how they must be missing him and of the sorrow he caused them. He then encounters courting couples. As noted earlier, the central panel (and remainder) of this terrace is dedicated to the nunnery run by the abbess Mahāyāni, with the final panel on this face devoted to the nuns themselves and their interaction with Arjuna, in particular the abbess who gives Arjuna wise counsel. The very last scene of this episode on the eastern wall shows Arjuna completing his ritual morning ablutions at the nunnery before departing to continue his quest (Brandes phs. 152–143).

As we have already seen, the eastern panel of the *beugel* deals with a number of issues, beginning with the birth of a son to the reigning queen and the fruit-laden tree, both of which are emblems of fecundity and intricately bound up with concepts of queenhood. There is the capture-acquisition of the *kinnarī* princess, Manoharā, whom Sudhana takes as bride and future queen, with the last scene on the eastern wall showing either Sudhana as he leaves his bride, setting out from the palace to fulfil his father's quest, or, as seems more likely, Manoharā leaving Sudhana's palace. Ostensibly, a similar struggle is going on in the first terrace (*Aji Dharma*) below. It has been suggested that Aji Dharma also struggles for the woman he desires as queen and, indeed, in the last scene on the eastern face, she leads the group into its finale.

NORTHERN FACE

Scene 11

Marred by the loss of the top row of stones, the first scene (Fig. 12.11) is long and set in a compound—whether it is a palace or hermitage is difficult to say. There are a number of *bale*—at least three—one of which is enclosed and has a central staircase. A fourth structure, second from left, with the suggestion of a Meru-roof, may be an offering place or, given perspective, a Candi set further away. Several water pots and plants are neatly arranged. Six figures occupy this scene: two are at the front of the open *bale*; they face a young male figure seated on the ground. The first figure is clearly priestly, his hair is clearly bound up and swathed into a large turban-like arrangement; he stands holding a (woven?) basket-like receptacle. The headdress of the other figure, however, is entirely different. It appears to have a crown-like diadem at the front and the swathing sits in an odd shape right at the back of the head, rather than on top. Just how one is to resolve this figure is problematic: on the one hand, the swathing suggests a member of the priestly class; on the other, his facial features are somewhat gross and his manner suggests a certain arrogance or what might be a regal pose—possibly a form of *lalitāsana*, a posture of relaxation or serenity adopted



Fig. 12.11: Introduction of the two Brahmins (?) into the tale. (Brandes phs. 91, 90, 89)

by royal figures and deities.⁴⁴ He points (in either an accusatory or directional gesture) towards the young male figure who is seated on the ground before him, holding his left hand over his ear, his right hand to his chin. In the background, between the accusatory 'priest' and the young male, is a small servant-like figure. Immediately behind the young male are two more figures, one of which leans against, or is being held by, the other. Since these last two are not separated from the previous figures by any formal dividing motif, they are considered here as perhaps belonging to the one scene or within the same venue.

Interpretation: At first glance, this scene would seem relatively easy to deal with inasmuch as the major participants are mostly identifiable from the *avadāna*. However, placing the action into the contextual flow of that version proves to be a little more difficult. In one sense the scene follows the reference story in logical sequence, for we are told that it was through the insistence of the high priest that Sudhana was summoned to the court by his father. Actually, the story relates of two Brahmins: one attaches himself to Sudhana and the other becomes *purohita* to the king. While the two arrive at the court together, in reality they connive against each other as well as against the king and Sudhana. Are the two 'priestly' figures the Brahmins? Or, given that they have split up on arrival in North Pañcāla, is one a Brahman and the other the king—Sudhana's father—in ascetic garb?

Sudhana's posture at this point is intriguing: he is seated on the ground, lower than the two figures at the *bale*, yet his gesture is not entirely one of obeisance (Fig. 12.11a). His left hand is held to his ear, either covering or cupping it. A comparison with Fig. 12.11 reveals that a great deal of deterioration has occurred since Brandes' photographs were taken. Sudhana's left arm is now all but missing—only his hand remains at his ear. There is enough detail left in the face, however, to recognize a similarity with the seated character in Fig. 12.3. The mood of the

44. In his description of these figures, Brandes offers no opinion as to who or what they might represent. The pose is similar to one displayed by a later figure in Scene 19 (see Fig. 12.19a). See also Brandes phs. 156 and 157 for renditions of *viku/guru* figures in the *Pārthayajña* reliefs.



Fig. 12.11a: Detail of Brandes ph. 92. (Photo: author)

scene is certainly not one of tranquillity and one may guess that Sudhana is less than pleased with what he is hearing. But whether his consternation is due to what he hears from the pair in front of him or from those behind is not possible to say. The role of the tiny figure here is unclear but may be explained later in Scene 12.

The two figures behind the young male are also intriguing (see Fig. 12.11b). Lacking a formal dividing motif between these two groups, we might assume that all are in the same locale. Identification is further hampered by the row of missing stones at the top, resulting in details of the upright figure being lost.

While appearing to be well dressed, the upright figure has bare arms and does not appear to be wearing arm jewellery; the second figure is not clear enough to be positively identified. The upright figure holds something (not identifiable) in the right hand, while the left hand appears to be at or around the other's throat.

The leaning figure is slimmer, more like the build of Sudhana, although the hairstyle is clearly



Fig. 12.11b: Detail of Brandes ph. 89.

different, seeming rather more feminine. The demeanour of this figure is also curious—even though ‘she’ appears to be held by the throat, there does not appear to be any aggression.⁴⁵ On the contrary, there is almost a feeling of helpless submission. On the one hand, we know from the *avadāna* that before Sudhana left to do his father’s bidding, he gave Manoharā’s head jewel to his sympathetic mother with the request that it should be returned to Manoharā should the latter encounter danger.

On the other hand, could this be Sudhana’s mother returning the head jewel to her daughter-in-law? The Khotanese text has the following de-

45. On one of my visits to Jago, I took the opportunity of asking Rdn. Bambang Soetrisno (caretaker of Jago and author of the earlier mentioned *Sejarah Percandian Daerah Malang*) for his opinion on these two figures. He proffered that these two figures were embracing each other (*memeluk*). However, in his publication he describes them as fighting (*berkelahi*).

scription of Sudhana's mother returning the head jewel to Manoharā:

When the queen Sūryaprabhā knew the circumstance she gave the brilliant jewel and likewise the robe to her. She so said to her, Please to accept this back from me, my daughter. Manoharā, prostrate on her breast, cried out aloud... (Bailey 1966: 511)

The *Mahāvastujātaka* version relates that after learning that Manoharā had obeyed his wishes and left the court, the king sent for Sudhana and embraced him and comforted him. However, while Sudhana as the leaning figure could be a possibility, this would seem to be precluded by the hairstyle and dress—the hair being more reminiscent of the female in Fig. 12.9b.

Regarding the dwarfish figure that can be seen near the *bale* in Figs. 12.11 and 12.11a (detail), it is also related in the *jātaka* that, although under guard, Sudhana was able to leave the court secretly with one devoted companion, Vasantaka, to search for Manoharā. A similar figure appears with Sudhana in the next scene (Scene 12, Fig. 12.12). Perhaps this figure is filling a similar role to Vasantaka of the *jātaka*—although he does not appear in the reliefs after Scene 12.

To summarize, the most likely scenario for the episode depicted is that Sudhana, having been summoned by the *purohita* (or king) to the court, hears that he must leave the court immediately to fight the rebels in the mountains. Perhaps he is also hearing that Manoharā is to be, or has already been, ousted. This would logically explain the two figures immediately behind Sudhana: one may well be Manoharā, the other the queen (Sudhana's mother) who is returning Manoharā's head jewel so that the *kinnarī* princess might escape danger in Sudhana's absence.

Parallel themes: As regards parallel themes with the stories on the other terraces, at this point the *Pārthayajña* above shows Arjuna and the *panakawan* leaving Mahāyanī's hermitage (the gateway is visible) to begin what will turn out to be a most traumatic journey through the forest. There, isolated deep in the woods during a storm, he will face the demons of his inner self (Brandes phs. 142–38). Notably, on the *beugel*, Sudhana is also

leaving to undertake an equally traumatic journey. On the first terrace, directly below the compound of the Sudhana scene, are the opening scenes of the *Kuñjarakarṇa* tale. Kuñjarakarṇa is in Vairocana's heaven, where the Omniscient One advises Kuñjarakarṇa that he is to journey through hell to see its punishments for himself and thus strengthen his resolve to seek enlightenment. In the next scene, Kuñjarakarṇa is seeking directions from the demon of the crossroads as to the correct route to hell—a beneficial journey but also a harrowing one (Brandes phs. 34–33). The parallel between the three terraces at this point is indeed striking.

Scene 12

Part of the previous scene has been incorporated into Fig. 12.12 to show the relationship between the figures and the separation provided by the vegetal motifs. Scene 12 clearly shows the three figures (framed in the centre) as being in a forest setting. Once again, damage to the head and upper torso of the thickset figure prevents easy recognition of its category or character, although the three-quarter length coat with its long sleeves might suggest a member of the priestly class.⁴⁶ The left hand of this figure is extended towards the young male—the fingertips holding something small—as if to pass it to the young male whose hands, in a reverential pose, make ready to receive it. Behind the thickset figure stands a dwarfish figure wearing a large swathed headpiece.

Interpretation: From the *avadāna* we know that Sudhana sought information regarding Manoharā from his mother and from the *ṛṣi* who lived near the lake frequented by the *kinnarī* maidens.⁴⁷ It appears that Manoharā had been forced to leave Sudhana's palace by the intrigues of the *purohita*, which eventually put her life in danger. The

46. See for example, Brandes ph. 164, which shows Arjuna meeting with the sage, Dvaipāyana, at the Īṅgitāmṛtapada hermitage (second terrace, *Pārthayajña*).

47. Taking the context of the *avadāna* into account, it will be immediately obvious that—thus far at least—the episode of Sudhana's military commitment in the mountains has not been recounted in the reliefs. This matter will be taken up again later in this work.



Fig. 12.12: Sudhana takes advice for his journey. (Brandes phs. 89, 88)

queen had then returned the head jewel with which Manoharā was able to make good on her escape. Before returning to the *kinnarī* kingdom, however, Manoharā also gave her ring to a *ṛṣi* to keep for Sudhana, together with instructions for the hard and perilous journey to the land of the *kinnaris*, should the prince wish to follow her. The thick-set figure in this scene is certainly different to the rotund figure of the previous scene. The garb is different: the arms are covered—indeed the upper garment has the appearance of a coat. The dress and setting would seem to suggest that this is the *ṛṣi* handing the ring to Sudhana, together with directions for the journey to the *kinnarī* kingdom. This is further borne out in the next scene (13), where a round object is clearly visible around Sudhana's neck. Regarding the short figure to the left, his posture and body build are similar to the tiny figure present in Scene 11—to identify them as one and the same would seem reasonable.

Parallel themes: There is an interesting parallel below, on the first terrace, where Kuñjarakarna has met with the guardian of the crossroads who is also giving him directions as to which path to take to hell (Brandes ph. 34). In the first of two wide scenes of the *Pāthayajña* above, Arjuna and the *panakawan* are at the start of their journey in the forest, and in the second the group has encountered a rainstorm (Brandes phs. 141–139). Above the second terrace, the walls are no longer in situ.



Fig. 12.13: Sudhana starts his journey. (Brandes ph. 88)

Scene 13

Surrounded still by scrolling rock and vegetal motifs, the young male (highlighted) walks on alone, looking back over his shoulder as if to the previous scene (Figs. 12.13, 12.13a).

Interpretation: As noted earlier, this looking back to a previous scene seems to infer the recalling of previously given counsel. Of importance is the object that the figure now wears at his neck (Fig. 12.13a). It is a protruding, round flat 'lump' with a slight depression at its centre. In the context of the

tale, I am fairly confident in identifying this figure as Sudhana wearing Manoharā's ring tied around his neck as his means of carrying it—somewhat like an amulet. Thus we may assume that his quest for Manoharā, fraught with danger so we are told, has begun.

Parallel themes: There are very clear parallels with this and ensuing scenes on all the other terraces. Kuñjarakarna's journey through hell has just begun on the first terrace below, as has Arjuna's night of terror during his journey through the 'enchanted' forest on the second terrace, above (*Pārthayajña*). Also, on the third terrace, the major battle of the *Arjunavivāha*, with all its associated traumas, would have just been unfolding in a scene that once wholly occupied the major panel of the northern face of the third terrace.



Fig. 12.13a: Detail. (Photo: author)

Scene 14

This long scene (highlighted) is set in a direct vertical line beneath the central panels of the upper

terraces (Fig. 12.14). It includes two sets of water motifs separated by what appears to be the young male (face and head damaged, but identifiable by the distinctive tie in his *kain*), who is in a crouching position on one knee, supported and surrounded by a long, undulating ribbon motif ending in the familiar curling flame motif. The left bank of the first water motif shows a rocky shoreline (curling, knobby rock motifs) and some vegetation. The surface of the water in the first section is different to that in the second, being more agitated in appearance. The ripple lines in the second body of water are smoother and more ordered. Though damaged, the head of the central figure is looking forward. Of note, the ribbon-like motif is the same as that employed elsewhere on the shrine to indicate flying.⁴⁸ If one looks closely, an object is still present around the neck, but now what appears to be a jacket has also been added.

Interpretation: I have no doubt that this scene represents a portion of Sudhana's journey to the *kinnarī* kingdom in search of Manoharā. The more disturbed nature of the water as suggested by the first group of motifs, together with the presence of tiny heads and the appearance of scales on the undulating shapes, indicates that this is the river of snakes which could only be passed, according to the story, by means of magical charms. The second water motif is made up of much flatter, longer ripple lines, suggesting that the water surface is smoother and more tranquil than the previous group. Whether this is the second river ('of reeds') or a device to indicate the working power of the charm on the same body of water, it is difficult to say. The *avadāna* does not mention what form the snake charm took—perhaps the ring—but as noted above in the detail of this scene (Fig. 12.14a), Sudhana is also wearing what appears to be a tiny jacket. While the *Sudhana* tale says nothing about a jacket, the Old Javanese *Arjunavivāha* relates that

48. See for example in the *Aji Dharma* reliefs (first terrace) where figures of an ascetic and Brahman and their proximity to the sun makes it certain they are flying (Brandes ph. 40). The same ribbon motif is also employed in the *Arjunavivāha* reliefs to portray Arjuna and the two *gandharva* messengers flying to Indra's heaven (Brandes ph. 187), although they are also provided with swing motifs as aids to their flight.



Fig. 12.14: Sudhana crosses two (?) rivers. (Brandes phs. 87, 86)



Fig. 12.14a: Detail. (Photo: author)

the *gandharvas* gave Arjuna a magic jacket and a pair of sandals, which were the means of his flight to Indra's heaven.⁴⁹

49. See Zoetmulder (1974: 235). See also Brandes ph. 187: it is not possible to confirm in the photo whether Arjuna is wearing the items spoken of in the *kakavin*.

Parallel themes: As mentioned, this scene of Sudhana's encounter with the river of snakes is beautifully paralleled on the terraces above and below. On the first terrace (below), Kuñjarakarna continues his sightseeing tour of hell past lines of suffering sinners tormented and goaded by their animal-headed keepers. Above, on the second terrace, Arjuna is also continuing his journey through the 'enchanted forest' where he is about to encounter tree monsters, demonic apparitions, copulating animals, etc., and on the third terrace, as noted, the whole of the major panel would have dealt with the battle waged by Arjuna and his army of gods against the demonic hordes led by Nivātakavaca.

Scenes 15, 16, 17, and 18

This tableau consists of four tightly interrelated and overlapping scenes, which requires them to be condensed into one illustration.⁵⁰

Scene 15

The forest motifs at the extreme left end adjoin the water motifs of the previous scene and overall, form a surround for the single figure who now

50. This convention of overlapping scenes is not an isolated case on Jago. Other notable examples are the tableau illustrating Arjuna's sojourn in Mahāyāni's hermitage on the second terrace in an episode from the *Pārthayajña*—and a parallel scene from the *Kuñjarakarna* on the first terrace below (see also Fig. 12.18a).



Fig. 12.15: Sudhana's arrival at the court of King Druma. (Brandes phs. 86, 85, 84)



Fig. 12.15a: Sudhana approaches the *kinnarī* palace. (Detail of Fig. 12.15)

approaches the wall (without gateway) of an inhabited compound (Fig. 12.15). However, while at first glance the clothing is certainly that of the young man from previous scenes, a close inspection of Fig. 12.15a suggests that he has become somewhat dishevelled, his hair is not quite as it was, and he has grown a moustache. It is also possible that his ribs are showing. Nowadays, the figure is so deteriorated that the facial features are no longer evident at all.

Interpretation: The *avadāna* relates that having crossed the last of the rivers, Sudhana reached a land 'rich in bushes'. It further tells that he must meet and subdue 500 *yakṣa* who dwell there, but that this place was also the capital city of the *kinnarī* king. We are not shown the *yakṣa* or the *kinnarī* maidens who, in the context of the tale, came to draw water for Manoharā's bath from a pond near where Sudhana stood gazing at the city. Unlike Borobudur, which presents a beautiful depiction of this episode, Jago does not show Sudhana dropping Manoharā's ring into one of the water jugs. But neither is the ring to be seen now around Sudhana's neck, nor is he wearing the jacket of the previous scene.



Fig. 12.16: Manoharā receives the ring. (Detail of Fig. 12.15)

Parallel themes: If we were to look for a parallel among the other reliefs, then the most notable one would be on the first terrace directly below, where Kuñjara-karṇa is coming to the end of his tour through hell and in an almost identical scene is also approaching the wall of a compound (Brandes ph. 31).

Scene 16

The central setting in the tableau shown in Fig. 12.15 is a large *bale* in the foreground of a compound, separated from the previous scene by the wall. A smaller *bale* is situated in the background. To the left of the main *bale* stands a bejewelled female figure (see Fig. 12.15 and detail, Fig. 12.16), her long hair trailing down over her left shoulder. She appears to be proceeding towards the *bale*, but with her head turned as if looking back towards the approaching figure of the male described in the previous scene. Her left hand is upraised, clasping something small, while her right arm hangs by her side.⁵¹

51. Brandes (1904: 54) also noted that she seemed to be holding something.



Fig. 12.17: Sudhana (or the queen?) with King Druma. (Detail of Fig. 12.15)

Scene 17

There are two levels in the large *bale* (see Fig. 12.15 and detail, Fig. 12.17). On the upper level, a figure sits as if listening to a second figure on the lower level, who is seated in the pose of obedience, hands joined in *sambah*. Due to corrosion, the sex of neither figure is immediately obvious. The hairstyle of the lower figure is certainly different from that of the female figures shown at either side, outside the *bale* (see Figs. 12.15, 12.16, and 12.18), and in fact is closer to that of the upper figure. However, the upper-body jewellery on the lower figure is closer to that worn by the females outside. Brandes (1904: 54) suggested that the lower figure is female, and we will return to this possibility later in the discussion. While the jewellery on the lower figure is reasonably well defined, the upper figure is too damaged for any such adornments to be clear.

Scene 18

On the far (right-hand) side of the *bale* (Fig. 12.15 and also 12.18 detail), a figure that is obviously female⁵² heads back towards the *bale*, again looking

52. There is just enough detail left of the flowing hair over the shoulder to suggest that it is a similar, or the same, female figure as that in Fig. 12.16.



Fig. 12.18: Manoharā gazes out through the gateway. (Detail of Fig. 12.15)

back over her shoulder—this time in the opposite direction, towards the gate in the far wall.

Interpretation of Scenes 15, 16, 17, and 18: We know from the source tale that Manoharā received notice (in the form of her ring) that Sudhana had arrived, so it would seem in order to suggest that the figure in Scene 16 (and detail Fig. 12.16) is Manoharā. Recognizing her ring and realizing that Sudhana has come for her after all, she looks back over her shoulder in the direction of his approach as she goes towards the court of her father. While the vestiges of the two figures in the *bale* do not give us much to go on, the raised position of one figure, while the lower sits respectfully, suggests that the former has supremacy and may be King Druma himself. As for the lower figure, I have already noted that the hair is different from either of the two female figures outside the *bale*. The *avadāna* relates that Manoharā did speak to her father about the arrival of Sudhana, but that it was necessary to both cool his anger and to dress Sudhana in more

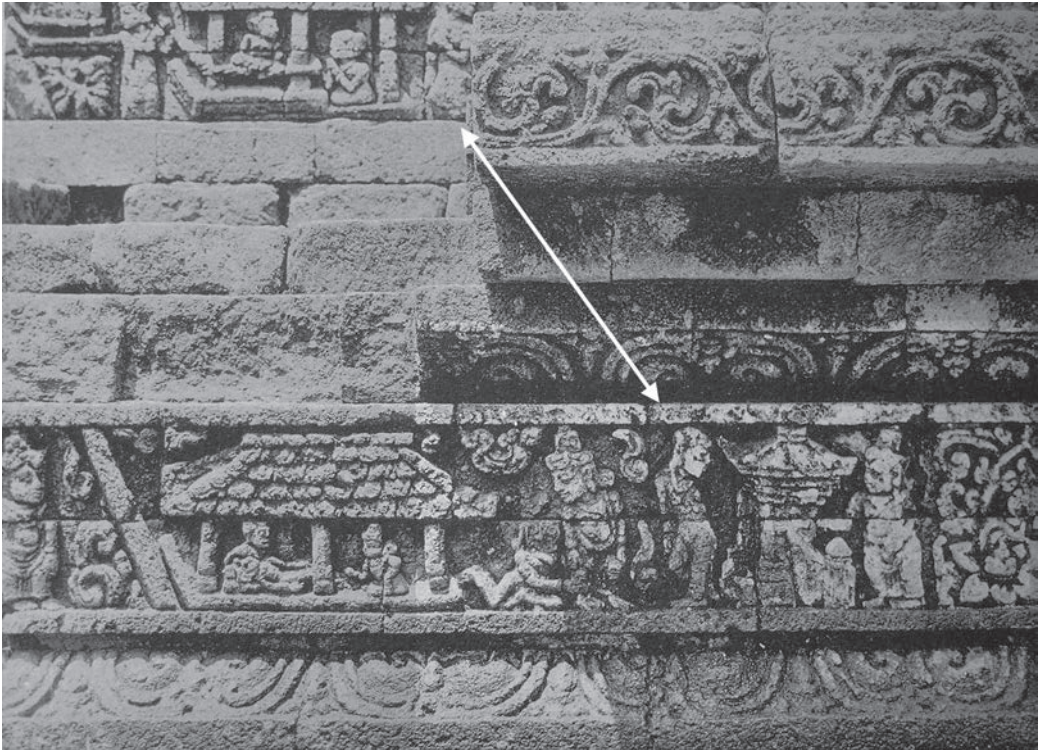


Fig. 12.18a: First terrace (*Kuñjarakarṇa*), the bale of King Pūrṇavijaya directly below that of King Druma on the *beugel* (top left). (Brandes ph. 30)

princely finery than what he had arrived in, before presenting him to her father. In such a context, it could be suggested that the figure on the lower level of the *bale* is Sudhana. However, there is another important and more plausible alternative for the two seated figures to be found in a source other than the *avadāna*, and we will return shortly to its consideration.

In the last scene of this tableau (Fig. 12.15), we see Manoharā again, this time heading back towards the *bale*, but with her head turned, gazing somewhat anxiously or disconsolately out through a gate in a wall (see Fig. 12.18, detail) towards a group of people outside.

Parallel themes: To explain the duplication of Manoharā in the same tableau, it will be helpful to look at the parallel scene directly below on the first terrace (Fig. 12.18a). The layout of Sudhana's arrival at the court of King Druma is remarkably similar to Kuṇḍarakarṇa's arrival at the court of his friend, King Pūrṇavijaya.

Kuṇḍarakarṇa has come to warn the king that he is shortly to be punished in hell for his transgressions. Earlier, for his own good, Kuṇḍarakarṇa had been sent by Buddha Vairocana on a journey to see the torments of hell so that the demon ascetic might avoid such punishments himself. So at the far left of Fig. 12.18a we see Kuṇḍarakarṇa, having finished his journey, arriving at the compound—in much the same way as Sudhana arrives at the compound of King Druma after his traumatic journey. Compacted into the next scene is the *bale* where Queen Gandhavatī reclines with King Pūrṇavijaya (prostrate, head on her lap), and Kuṇḍarakarṇa is seated opposite them. Immediately then, outside the *bale* (to the right), we find Kuṇḍarakarṇa again, with Pūrṇavijaya pleading at his knees for help. Beyond this pair, just inside the gate in the wall, we see the queen once again, this time heading back towards the *bale* but half-turned, gazing back over her shoulder through the gateway to the departing figures of Pūrṇavijaya, Kuṇḍarakarṇa, and the royal entourage (out of view in this illustration; see Brandes ph. 30/29). Perhaps displaying a little more despondency, the posture of Queen Gandhavatī in this last scene is nevertheless very much like that of Manoharā almost directly above (connected by arrow in Fig. 18a), who is also

gazing through the gate to a retinue of persons of similar numbers.

It is interesting that although the trauma of a dangerous journey is over—at least for the heroes of the first terrace and *beugel*—tension still abounds. It can clearly be seen in King Pūrṇavijaya's panic and the grief of the queen at his departure. Although it is not indicated as clearly in the Sudhana relief, we know from the story that King Druma was at first angry enough to kill Sudhana, and we see that there is also a certain anxiety about Manoharā's posture as she looks towards and through the gate. Perhaps we can draw the conclusion from this (and as echoed in the Kuṇḍarakarṇa panel)⁵³ that Sudhana has had to leave her again and that danger is still imminent for him.

Scene 19

This next scene (Fig. 12.19), to which Manoharā appears to direct her gaze (from the left side through the gate), takes place outside the compound (no buildings evident). It is dominated by a regal figure who sits on a low bench in *lalitāsana*. His eyes are bulbous; his right hand rests on his hip, while the left hand holds a long, thin object, suggested by Brandes (1904: 54) to be a *lontar*. He is attended by five other persons: one at his right and four at his left. The one at his right is described by Brandes as a servant who holds a box, probably for betel. At his left, the first figure is seated in the posture of obeisance, completely attentive to the regal figure. Next, are two seated figures in conversation with each other—they are wearing a peculiar kind of cap that is also worn by the attendants of Vairocana in the *Kuṇḍarakarṇa* tale on the first terrace.⁵⁴ Due to a missing course of stones, the last male figure (standing) is headless. He stands, arms crossed over the chest; the tie of his *kain* is not unlike the one found in earlier depictions of Sudhana.

Interpretation: The figure who sits in *sambhā* (Fig. 12.19b), also described by Brandes as female,

53. Above, on the second terrace, Arjuna is still in the forest of frightening, demonic apparitions. Above this again, on the central panel of the third terrace, Arjuna would have still been embroiled in the great battle against the demon army of Nivātakavaca (panel missing).

54. See for example Brandes phs. 28 and 105.



Fig. 12.19: The *kinnarī* queen pleads with King Druma, on behalf of Sudhana and Manoharā (?). (Brandes phs. 84, 83)



Fig. 12.19b: Detail. (Photo: author)

bears great similarity to the figure seated on the lower level of the *bale* of the previous scene (Fig. 12.17), in terms of the posture, hair, etc. On the other hand, from the context of the *avadāna* it could also be Sudhana, who has been restored to a state of refinement in order to be presented to King Druma. Whether the royal figure with the 'sceptre'



Fig. 12.19a: Detail. (Brandes ph. 83)

is the same as the one in Fig. 12.17 is uncertain, although the hairstyle and regal bearing suggest the possibility.⁵⁵

55. The iconographic features of the royal figure of Druma, king of the *kinnara*, seem to bear analogies to those of Vaiśravaṇa, king of the *yakṣa*; renditions of Vaiśravaṇa in Asian art frequently depict him seated in *lalitāsana*, also with bulging eyes, holding a jewel-sceptre in one hand and a jewel-spitting mongoose or sometimes a stupa in the other. In the *avadāna*, Manoharā related to Sudhana that he would come to a land rich in bushes where he would have to overcome the 500 *yakṣa* who dwelt there, and where he would find the capital of the king of the *kinnara*. It is possible that this panel reflects a conflation of ideas and iconographical features, resulting in the assimilation of



Fig. 12.20a: Overlap and continuation of Scene 20. (Brandes phs. 82, 81)

If these two figures are King Druma and Sudhana, then the simple interpretation of the entire group would be that the *kinnarī* king is organizing the tests (archery and other martial skills) through which Sudhana will prove his suitability to be the husband of Manoharā. To that end, perhaps it is a bow and/or arrow that the royal figure holds, and Sudhana is making ready to receive it.

If however Brandes is right, i.e. the figure making obeisance in this scene and the previous one is female, then the *avadāna* is of no help since this female cannot be Manoharā, whose depiction is entirely different. This point is significant and will be taken up again shortly.

Parallel themes: While there is an important parallel for this scene in the *Pārthayajña* reliefs directly above, it may serve us well to look at the content of the next (and last) remaining scenes in this story, returning later to draw what conclusions are then possible.

Scene 20

Between Scenes 19 and 20, a length (0.56 metres) of stonework has been only partially carved, as can be seen at the left-hand end of Fig. 12.20b. Thus we

kinnara and *yakṣa* on the one hand, and of Druma and Vaiśravaṇa on the other. In the *Mahābhārata*, King Druma is associated with Kuvera (Vaiśravaṇa) as a member of the latter's court (Dezső 2014: 76). The depiction of Vaiśravaṇa on the northern face of Jago would have certain significance since he is the Guardian of the North.



Fig. 12.20b: Uncarved stonework and beginning of Scene 20. (Brandes ph. 82)

must consider that possibly the scene was unfinished. From this point to the end of the *beugel* at the western corner, stones are randomly missing from the upper row of the narrative.

This long scene—here spread across Figs. 12.20a, 12.20b, and 12.20c—contains approximately twelve figures,⁵⁶ at least two of which are short and podgy like *panakawan* and are on their hands and knees. Viewing the postures of the first half-dozen figures, it is impossible to say whether it is a form of cooperative activity or whether an altercation of some sort is in progress. At the far end of the scene there is a wall (Fig. 12.20c), beyond which there is a *bale* (also partly visible at left in Fig. 12.21), from where begins the next scene.

56. There are quite possibly more than twelve, but due to weathering some are nothing more than indistinct shapes.



Fig. 12.20c: Continuation of Scene 20. (Brandes ph. 80)

Scene 21

This scene (Fig. 12.21) opens at left with a sloping wall and an enclosed *bale* within a compound (the wall can be seen at far right of Fig. 12.20c). There is also a tree in a *kurunian* beside the *bale*.

Whether there was once anyone or anything to be seen inside the open doorway of the *bale* is now impossible to say. Proceeding from the *bale* to the gateway are three figures. The first two figures (from the left) are female, with a clearly defined feminine form. Both appear bejewelled, the second very heavily at the neck and waist. The second female also has long hair falling over her shoulder in a style that is reminiscent of earlier depictions of Manoharā (see Fig. 12.9b), but damage to facial features makes certainty difficult. She proceeds half-turned, gesturing to the first female behind her as if in conversation. The third figure, in the style of a *panakawan*, is possibly female. The gateway is very similar to the gateway in Fig. 19 though the position of the tree in its surround is slightly different.

Proceeding from the gateway of the previous scene are another nine figures walking in single file in the same direction as the three inside the gate—with the possibility that this scene is a continuation of the previous one shown in Fig. 12.21. In Fig. 12.21b only five are included (one of whom is missing the

upper body)—the balance appear in Fig. 12.21c. The back four at least seem to be bare-topped, dressed in long sarongs, and appear to be in conversation with each other. Each holds aloft a platter, similarly piled with what appears to be food or offerings. Weathering has made it difficult to determine if the processional figures are all the same gender. Certainly they are more plainly attired than the two main females in the previous scene. Between the second and third, and third and fourth figures are curling motifs such as have been randomly noted throughout the series.

Due to missing stones from the upper course, we cannot see if the figures which form the balance of the group in the preceding photo are also bearing platters or other items. However, the leading figure in the procession is complete and carries a staff to which something (a banner, flag?) is attached at the top end. The total procession of nine figures approaches a tenth, similarly dressed figure standing at the end of the scene. While the gender of the figure carrying the banner is not clear, this last figure would appear to be male. He is set apart from the procession by two sets of large, decorated, scrolling motifs set symmetrically on either side of him. He stands, facing back towards those approaching. This scene, the last on the northern face of the *beugel*, is also the last in the *Sudhana*



Fig. 12.2i: A retinue bearing offerings. (Brandes phs. 79, 78, 77)



Fig. 12.21a: Detail showing last three figures in retinue.



Fig. 12.21b: Detail showing five figures at centre of retinue.



Fig. 12.21c: Detail showing leading figures in retinue.

the venue seems to be outside the compound). What kind of an implement the 'kinnarī king' would be holding in such circumstances is uncertain. Brandes suggested that the figure holds a *lontar*, but the object appears to be pointed at least at the top end. Concerning the tasks set for Sudhana by King Druma, the *avadāna* narrates that Sudhana, amid dance and music, cut seven golden stems with a sword that looked like the leaf of a blue lotus into small fragments, and shot an arrow through seven palm trees, seven kettledrums, and seven boars (Ralston 1906: 72). The *avadāna* then relates that Sudhana was required to pick out Manoharā from a thousand *kinnarī* just like her, which he duly accomplished. Now satisfied with Sudhana, King Druma calls his people forth to honour him, after which the king formally presents Manoharā to Sudhana.

If one could understand precisely what actions are taking place in Scene 20 (Figs. 12.20a, 12.20b, and 12.20c) on Jago, then perhaps the total context of the final scenes would fall into place. Though the reliefs have suffered deterioration, some of the figures in Scene 20 clearly exhibit the features of coarse beings, and others are strangely attired, with two having unidentifiable items around their necks. The implements or items they hold are largely unrecognizable. Only one figure (fourth from the left) shows any affinity with the familiar Sudhana figure from the rest of the series. Progressing further along the same scene, the action appears increasingly frenetic—but are the characters fighting or dancing? In any event, the action does not seem to match the tasks set for Sudhana by King Druma, unlike Borobudur where the drama of the tests is beautifully portrayed. However, it may allude to the music, song, and dance described in the *avadāna*. It would then follow that the assessment tasks were deliberately not depicted or simply did not occur in the version being illustrated.

Allowing some latitude in identifying the action in this scene (20), perhaps the final scene (21) relates to Sudhana being required to pick out Manoharā from a line of *kinnarī* maidens who are clearly advancing towards him.⁵⁷ So why then does Jago not

go on to display the eventual outcome of attaining his beloved Manoharā—especially in light of ancient Javanese concepts of ideal kingship, where gaining the right queen is paramount? In the final episode of the tale, the couple live happily in King Druma's kingdom but eventually make their way back to Sudhana's kingdom, where they are received with great rejoicing. Jago makes no reference in its reliefs to this last part of the tale.

For a potentially more plausible possibility, let us return to Brandes' opinion that in Scenes 17 (Fig. 12.17) and 19 (see Figs. 12.19, 12.19a, and 12.19b) the two figures seated in obeisance are females. Here, we resort again to the Khotanese text, which relates that when Manoharā discovered the ring and thus the arrival of Sudhana, she was fearful of her father's reaction and went first to her mother. The queen was sympathetic to her daughter and full of admiration for the ordeals of Sudhana's twelve-year journey to find Manoharā. She ordered that Sudhana be brought to her. Being much taken with him, the queen nevertheless warned that 'King Druma threatens violently'. She therefore undertook to inform the king herself; when the king had heard, he imposed upon Sudhana 'unlimited punishment, harsh threats, abusive speech' (Bailey 1966: 513). If these two very similar figures sitting in *sambhā* are, as Brandes suggests, female, could they both represent the queen? It would then mean that in Scene 17 the queen is informing the king of Sudhana's arrival, and in Scene 19 she pleads with the king on behalf of Sudhana who awaits the king's judgement. This would explain Manoharā's consternation in the previous scene as she looks out through the gate (Fig. 12.18). She is obviously very much connected to the outcome of activities in the ensuing scene. In such an event, it may well be Sudhana who stands at the right-hand end of Scene 19 (Fig. 12.19) with arms folded across his chest. The Khotanese text does not detail what forms the punishment took, only that Sudhana 'went out invincible as a *kesarin* lion'; nor does the text mention the king's directive that Sudhana must

57. While it is reasonable not to expect that a thousand *kinnarī* or even a sizeable crowd could be displayed on Jago, it is interesting to note that there are only seven *kinnarī*

in the Pāli version (Jaini 1966: 552). As observed earlier, of the three figures inside the compound of Scene 21, one could easily pass for Manoharā, given her depiction in previous scenes.

pick out Manoharā from a number of her *kinnari* sisters.

Earlier, Scene 20 was considered from the possible aspects of fighting or dancing. The *Mahāvastu-jātaka* offers yet a third way of viewing this scene. Having been told by Manoharā that Sudhana had, after all, managed to reach the *kinnara* kingdom, there is no talk whatsoever by King Druma of retribution. In fact, he orders that the city and palace be festooned with all manner of finery and flowers and for the city elders and the army to go forth bedecked with flags and banners to meet Sudhana. When the commands have been carried out, a reception is arranged with great pomp, hosted by ‘several thousand Kinnaras and to the accompaniment of thousands of musical instruments’ (Jones 1952: 107). Thus, the *jātaka* certainly presents a plausible scenario for Scenes 20 and 21 on Jago. However, the *jātaka* says nothing of prior intervention by the queen.⁵⁸ For its part, the Khotanese text makes much of the queen’s role, but says nothing of welcoming festivities.⁵⁹ The *avadāna* does not mention the queen or receptions, but makes much of the punishment and conditions imposed on Sudhana, which he needed to undergo before being accepted as Manoharā’s husband.

Based on the evidence of the last few scenes, it is plain that neither the *Sudhanakumāravadāna* and the *Kinnarījātaka* (*Mahāvastu*), nor the Khotanese text of Rddhiprabhāva, was the sole source of reference for the sculptors of the Sudhana-Manoharā tale on Jago. However, if the matter of an interpretation of the last few scenes of the Sudhana tale still lies in doubt, perhaps our confusion was also shared by the sculptors themselves, for there is still the matter of the uncarved stonework between Scenes 19 and 20.

Parallel themes: An investigation of the reliefs above and below these final scenes of the *Sudhana* tale yields some interesting parallels, but little help in defining precisely what is taking place in these last scenes. For example, on the first terrace below (Brandes phs. 30–28) we find that Kuñjarakarṇa and King Pūrṇavijaya, accompanied by members of his court bearing offerings as well as a number of musicians,⁶⁰ have gone off to plead with Buddha Vairocana for a means of avoiding the terrible punishment in store for Pūrṇavijaya. In fact, Pūrṇavijaya’s entreaty to Vairocana (Brandes phs. 29, 28) exactly reflects the queen’s suggested entreaty to King Druma in the *Sudhana* tale directly above (Fig. 12.19), even down to the similarly dressed members in the two courts.

Continuing with the *Kuñjarakarṇa* tale below, King Pūrṇavijaya can be seen leaving his wife and home to undertake the journey to hell. He is followed by trident-wielding individuals. Curiously, at the end of the last scene (Brandes ph. 23) Pūrṇavijaya has turned his back on the direction to be travelled and now faces his armed pursuers, in the same way that Sudhana faces those who approach him at the end of the last scene in the *Sudhana* tale (see Fig. 12.21c).⁶¹ Taking now the parallels directly above on the second terrace, the *Pārthayajña* reveals a number of scenes relative to the appearance of the goddess Śrī Lakṣmī to Arjuna (Brandes phs. 134–30). The whole episode is spread over two large panels; thus, it would be reasonable to assume it had prime significance. In the first panel Śrī Lakṣmī appears in a blaze of dazzling light, which in effect puts an end to the darkness and the demonic apparitions that were plaguing his imagination as he journeyed through the forest. She reassures Arjuna by foretelling that he will be successful in his mission and then gives instruction on the ‘enemies in the innermost part of man that must be fought relentlessly’ (Zoetmulder 1974: 369). On Jago, as she does this, the positioning of the

58. Nor does it feature the *nāga*, Janmacitra, or the *amoghapāśa*; nor the Vaiśravaṇa episode of the prince being sent to put down a rebellion. Instead, Sudhana is held confined in his own palace and Manoharā is sent away. This latter possibility has already been noted in connection with Scene 11.

59. The Khotanese text tells of a *nāgarāja* and the *amoghapāśa*; it also tells of Sudhana conducting war against rebels in the mountains but does not mention Vaiśravaṇa.

60. These musicians, featured in two consecutive scenes, are located directly below the problematic scene of the *Sudhana* tale, which it is proposed may feature dancers.

61. These are the last scenes of the *Kuñjarakarṇa* on the northern wall. It is then continued on the western face of the *beugel* around the corner from where the *Sudhana* tale finishes (see Jago layout in Diagram 1).

goddess on the panel exactly parallels King Druma below, whereas it is (presumably) the queen who parallels Śrī Lakṣmī, successfully interceding on behalf of Sudhana. The last scene of the *Pārthayajña* on the northern face of the second terrace (Brandes pls: 128/127) shows Arjuna watching a procession of celestial beings comprising Kāma and Ratih with their attendants on the far side of a beautiful lake. In an ensuing panel around the corner, Kāma too will give words of guidance and encouragement. In the last panel of the *Arjunavivāha* on the northern face of the third terrace,⁶² there is also a group of divinities arranged around a small multi-roofed pavilion in which sits Arjuna, who has been crowned temporary king of Indra's heaven.

As can be seen from the above discussion of the last few scenes in the *Sudhana* tale on the northern face, visual and thematic parallels exist both above and below. Gods and goddesses are intervening on behalf of supplicants, enabling them to overcome their difficulties, with the end panels finishing with processions or groups of people or celestial beings attending or paying homage to a divine or victorious character. However, the significance of these 'parallels' comes to the fore when read from the base up, for it is then we can see an ascendancy of kingship. In the *Kuṇḍarakarṇa*, the king fearlessly sets out to undergo transformation and purification in his step towards enlightenment and Buddhahood. On the next level, the virtuous bodhisattva prince Sudhana, through his endurance and determination, has won the right to keep the *kinnarī* princess as wife and future queen. On the second terrace, Arjuna's austerities have won the initial help he needs on his quest to restore his kingdom to its rightful rulers (*Pārthayajña*). On the third terrace, we see that Arjuna's efforts on behalf of heaven in the war against the demons have earned him temporary rule in Indra's place as king of the gods (*Arjunavivāha*).

Just taking these four tales into consideration, it becomes clear that the choice of narratives was in no way a random affair for Jago, much less their

arrangement around the shrine. In terms of the *maṇḍala*,⁶³ the overall thematic parallel which runs vertically between narratives on the northern wall is plainly related to Amoghasiddhi, Jina-Buddha of the Northern Quarter, whose *abhaya-mudrā* signifies the Performance of Duty and the gift of the Absence of Fear, so clearly provided by the various divine and semi-divine beings.

CONCLUSION

With a survey and interpretation of the *Sudhana* narrative series now complete, I would like to recall once again Pal's earlier-mentioned views on the Newar *paubha* and propose that Jago's rendering, too, seems to be another 'variation which has taken on much local colour'. Working with three Buddhist versions of the *Sudhana* tale, I found many affinities as well as many differences; there were times when the venue and action could be attributed to one version or other, but the actors could not. On the other hand, depictions of Sudhana, the lake of Janmacitra, the introduction of Manoharā, the crossing of the river of snakes, Sudhana's arrival at the kingdom of the *kinnarī*, and Manoharā's discovery of the ring all seem obvious in their identification, so much so that, even taking into account the problems of the final episodes which seem to find clearer resolution in versions other than the *avadāna*, there can be little serious doubt at all that we are basically dealing with the right tale. This view is also supported, on the whole, by the system of thematic and visual parallels that plays such an important part in the arrangement (and consequently our understanding) of the narrative reliefs on this shrine.

Whether the *Sudhana* tale as depicted on Jago is the result of 'local colour', whether it is a composite of versions, or whether it belongs totally to an as-yet-unknown version is impossible for this writer to speculate on at the moment, for while at least three other narratives depicted on Jago find very close parallels in extant Old Javanese literature,⁶⁴

62. While this panel is the last on the northern face of the third terrace, it is not in direct vertical parallel with the final scenes on the first terrace, *beugel*, or second terrace. The third terrace bands the base of the *cella*, which is set well towards the back of the monument (see Diag.1).

63. Discussed briefly in note 22 above.

64. The *Kuṇḍarakarṇa*, *Pārthayajña*, and *Arjunavivāha* tales are all represented in Old Javanese *kakavin* literature, and in the main, the narrative reliefs on Jago seem to follow them fairly closely (excluding *panakawan*

such is not the case for the story of Sudhana and Manoharā, though we may suppose that it must have had some currency in Java given its depiction on Borobudur. As noted earlier, it is not inconceivable that the sculptors worked with multiple texts simultaneously, though the notion of them working with a localized tale that derived over time seems somewhat more attractive. Unfortunately, such a Javanese version, if it exists in manuscript form, still awaits discovery.

Another possibility to be considered is that the tale may indeed be a localized version ‘imported’ from outside the Javanese sphere. In consideration of other elements of the shrine, namely the statuary and some other decorative features, I have elsewhere supported input by influences (or even artisans themselves) from the Newars of Nepal (O’Brien 1993: 252–55).⁶⁵ History records that Newar artisans were in high demand in Central Asia during the period.⁶⁶ The most powerful of the

Buddhist sects in Tibet, the Sakya-pas, who ruled their large region virtually as abbot kings, used Newar artisans—architects, painters, sculptors, metal casters, etc.—almost exclusively. In fact, Pal (1985: 61–67) has noted that Sakya-pa domination is perhaps the reason why more of their *maṇḍalas* seem to have come down to us from that period. When the Sakya-pas came to occupy influential positions at the Yuan court as religious advisers, their preference for Newar artisans was extended there too.⁶⁷

Now, the iconography of Jago’s Amoghapaśa and that of the four companion statues closely follows a *sādhana* known to have been composed by the great Kashmiri scholar, Śākyaśrībhadrā (AD 1127–1225), much revered in Tibetan Buddhism, particularly by the Sakya-pa sect (O’Brien 1993: 252–55; Schoterman 1994: 154–77). Śākyaśrībhadrā was teacher to Sakya Paṇḍita, who became chief abbot of the Sakya-pas, the most powerful theocratic state in Tibet. It was Sakya Paṇḍita who gained the interest of the Mongol Khans of Yuan China in Tibetan Buddhism. Sakya Paṇḍita was eventually succeeded by his nephew, ‘Phags-pa, who went on to become Imperial Preceptor to Khubilai Khan. Such was the extent of his influence that Phags-pa was able not only to retain authority in his own court but was also given complete jurisdiction in religious matters in the Mongol court. The extraordinary popularity of Newar artisans in this Sino-Tibetan

characters). Sections of the *Aji Dharma* tale are also known in Old Javanese literature. The narrative reliefs that adorned the *cella* walls have been identified as the *Kṛiṣṇāyana*, but there remains too little of it left on Jago to assert that it followed the *kakavin* version of this tale, which deals with King Kṛiṣṇa’s desire to have Rukmiṇī as his wife and queen and his subsequent abduction of her.

65. In 1987 (O’Brien 1987: 139–41), I pointed to the distinct similarities between the decorative over- and under- bands of Jago’s bas-reliefs and the decorative bands on the ‘walls’ and ‘circles of protection’ that surround the ‘palace’ of the sovereign deity of linear *maṇḍalas*, in particular those *maṇḍalas* emanating from the Nepalese (Newar) and Tibetan (Sakya-pa) traditions. In her discussion of Nepali architecture, Slusser (1982 I: 145) asserts that there ‘can be little doubt that the Newar-style temple, in some of its variations at least, is a three dimensional *maṇḍala*’, noting the testimony of Nepali records, which frequently specify that a temple was constructed as a *maṇḍala*. She also draws attention to other similarities of features including the decorative cornices that encircle the Newar temple, which she also notes are comparable to the palace ‘walls’ of linear *maṇḍalas*. These same bands were also employed on later temples in East Java, e.g. Tigawangi and Surowono (Bernet Kempers 1959, pls. 296–98).

Of the five bands of bas-reliefs on Jago, it is notable that the *beugel* is the only one that does not carry either upper or lower decorated bands.

66. At the turn of the 13th century, Buddhism in northern India was in crisis, having come under attack by Muslim forces. The great Buddhist universities, including Nālandā

and Vikramaśīla, had been razed. Those scholars and artisans who managed to escape the onslaught, ‘fled with texts and portable icons into the Himalayas’ (Sharrock 2007: 252), with significant numbers settling in Nepal (von Schroeder 1981: 311). From there they spread even further eastwards, not inconceivably as far as Southeast Asia. In his study of the faces on the Bayon towers in Cambodia, Sharrock notes Jean Filliozat’s suggestion (1969: 47) that as a result of the enforced dispersion of learned Tantric masters there were ‘links between Nepalese and Khmer architecture at this period’ (Sharrock 2007: 252).

67. The great name among Newar artisans is Aniko, who went into the service of the Sakya-pas under ‘Phags-pa in 1260. His abilities as an artisan and architect gained him many major commissions under Khubilai Khan. However, as Tucci (1949: 277) notes, Aniko was only the first in a long line of Newar artists whose works are praised in the eulogies and chronicles of numerous monasteries, attesting to an ‘uninterrupted flow into Tibet of Nepalese artists and craftsmen’.

sphere is important because the time also coincides with the reign of Khubilai's Javanese adversary, King Kṛtanagara, builder and patron of Candi Jago and, like Khubilai, a follower of Tantric Buddhist doctrine and an aspiring empire builder (see Bade, this volume).

In his study of the iconographic concordance between Jago's statuary and iconographic details contained in the *sādhana* composed by Śākyaśrī-bhadra, Schoterman (1994: 154) felt inclined to support Bernet Kempers' (1933) opinion that 'the Candi Jago statues have been influenced by a new wave of Buddhism from Northeast India, which reached Java in the first part of the 13th century'. Even earlier, Brandes (1904: 83) also gave thought to Indian influences on the statuary—perhaps even non-Javanese artists—among other things, pointing to their Nāgarī inscriptions.⁶⁸ While exploring the bas-reliefs of Jago, I noted that the features of Śiva carved in the *Arjunavivāha* reliefs on the south face of the third terrace are strikingly similar to the features of Jago's Jina-Buddha statuary (cf. Locanā and Māmākī), so much so that I am of the opinion that whoever carved the statuary was—at least in part—involved in the carving of the bas-reliefs on the temple (O'Brien 1993: 254–55, pls. 31c and d).

Whether the iconography and/or craftsmanship of Jago's statuary was directly imported at the time or sourced locally from monks and artisans—refugees of the earlier Muslim onslaught in northern India and who were now established and practising in Java—is an argument which may never be resolved. But given the importance of the *maṇḍala* in understanding the layout of the narratives on Jago and the close similarity of a number of its decorative features to *maṇḍalas* of Newar influence, whether direct or indirect, it may well prove useful to examine the same regional sources for help with the *Sudhana*

tale, bearing in mind Pal's earlier-quoted comments on the popularity and diversity of the tale in Nepal.

APPENDIX

Inasmuch as missing scenes, lost features, and rampant ambiguity allows, the following is an attempt to summarize the scenes, bearing in mind that it is based on subjective choices from the multiple options provided by some scenes. The first thing that will have already become evident is that Sudhana appears to play a far more ubiquitous role in Jago's episodes than he is given in the literary works mentioned, such as the *avadāna*. As suggested earlier, this may be due to Jago's reliefs being based on an as yet unknown version; or there may have been more local and pragmatic reasons for featuring the Bodhisattva prince as a future heroic, steadfast, and capable king. From the lowest level and moving upwards to culmination in the *cella*, Jago clearly displays the ascendancy of divine kingship in accordance with principles of Esoteric Buddhism. For Kṛtanagara, the shrine's patron, the divine status would later climax in his own person: the oneness of Buddha/Śiva with that of a mortal king. The tale of Sudhana on his father's shrine was another step towards that goal. Exactly why it was chosen and how it—among the other narratives—participates in that progress is yet to be made clear.

Scene 1 The unjust king of South Pañcāla inspects his domains and finds them deserted by his citizens.

[2.7 metres of missing stonework containing an unknown number of scenes.]

Scene 2 King and queen of North Pañcāla; joy at the queen's pregnancy.

Scene 3 King and queen of North Pañcāla; presentation of their deferential son, Prince Sudhana.

Scene 4 Tree symbolizing the fertility and prosperity of North Pañcāla provided by the presence of the benevolent *nāga*,

68. Both Lokesh Chandra (1984) and Pal (1985: 145ff.) have published a selection of pages from Nepalese (Newar) sketchbooks containing images of deities, sometimes accompanied by their names and other iconographic details in Nāgarī (see for example Lokesh Chandra 1984: Sketchbook 1, p. 9 with two images of Amoghapaśa Lokeśvara). However, while very little survives from the 13th century, these examples existing from the 17th century may reflect practices from earlier times.

Janmacitra. A king (*nāga*?) in discussion with a respectful (but not submissive) Sudhana, who is perhaps being charged with protecting Janmacitra.

given a ring, a magic token to protect Sudhana on the arduous journey should he decide to follow her. There are also special instructions for the journey, which the *ṛṣi* passes on to Sudhana

Scene 5 Two figures (from Scene 4) crouch by the lake of Janmacitra, whose home is a cavern at the centre of the lake (or beneath the waves). Sudhana or snake charmer (?) approaches the cavern in a small boat.

Scene 13 Sudhana accepts the ring-token (now worn around his neck) and sets out on the journey, the words of the *ṛṣi* uppermost in his mind.

Scene 6 Sudhana receives a gift (the *amoghapāśa*) from the grateful *nāga* king.

Scene 14 Sudhana, now wearing a jacket, flies over the river of snakes.

Scene 7 Sudhana (wearing *amoghapāśa*) leaves the realm of the *nāgas*.

Scene 15 A gaunt and older-looking Sudhana arrives at the *kinnarī* kingdom, coming to the palace of King Druma.

Scene 8 Sudhana meets Manoharā who surrenders head jewel (?), her magic amulet for flight.

Scene 16 Manoharā recognizes the ring she had earlier left for safekeeping with the *ṛṣi*—she knows that Sudhana has arrived and fears her father's reaction.

Scene 9 Manoharā installed in Sudhana's palace quarters as his wife. Regal person instructs Sudhana to put aside Manoharā and present himself to the royal court. Manoharā is distraught.

Scene 17 Manoharā has informed her mother, the queen, who now faces King Druma with news, pleading on behalf of the couple.

Scene 10 Manoharā (or Sudhana?) undertakes a journey away from the quarters.

Scene 18 Manoharā watches fearfully through the gateway...

Scene 11 Sudhana meets with two priestly figures in the royal compound—he is loath to hear the instruction of the high priest. The loyal Vasantaka overhears their conversation. Meanwhile, Manoharā takes comfort from Sudhana's sympathetic mother and receives back the magic head-jewel (and cloth?). Alternatively, it may be Sudhana, full of grief, who visits his mother. In any event, both parts of this scene appear to be in the same venue.

Scene 19 ...as, outside the compound, King Druma confronts Sudhana, the queen still pleading at his feet.

Scene 20 Numerous figures fighting or dancing? Or, in the previous scene, King Druma is much pleased with his princely son-in-law and has ordered that the kingdom be prepared and decorated for celebration.

Scene 12 Vasantaka accompanies Sudhana to a friendly *ṛṣi* to whom Manoharā has

Scene 21 Manoharā goes forth from the compound with a retinue of *kinnarī* to meet and be reunited with Sudhana.

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